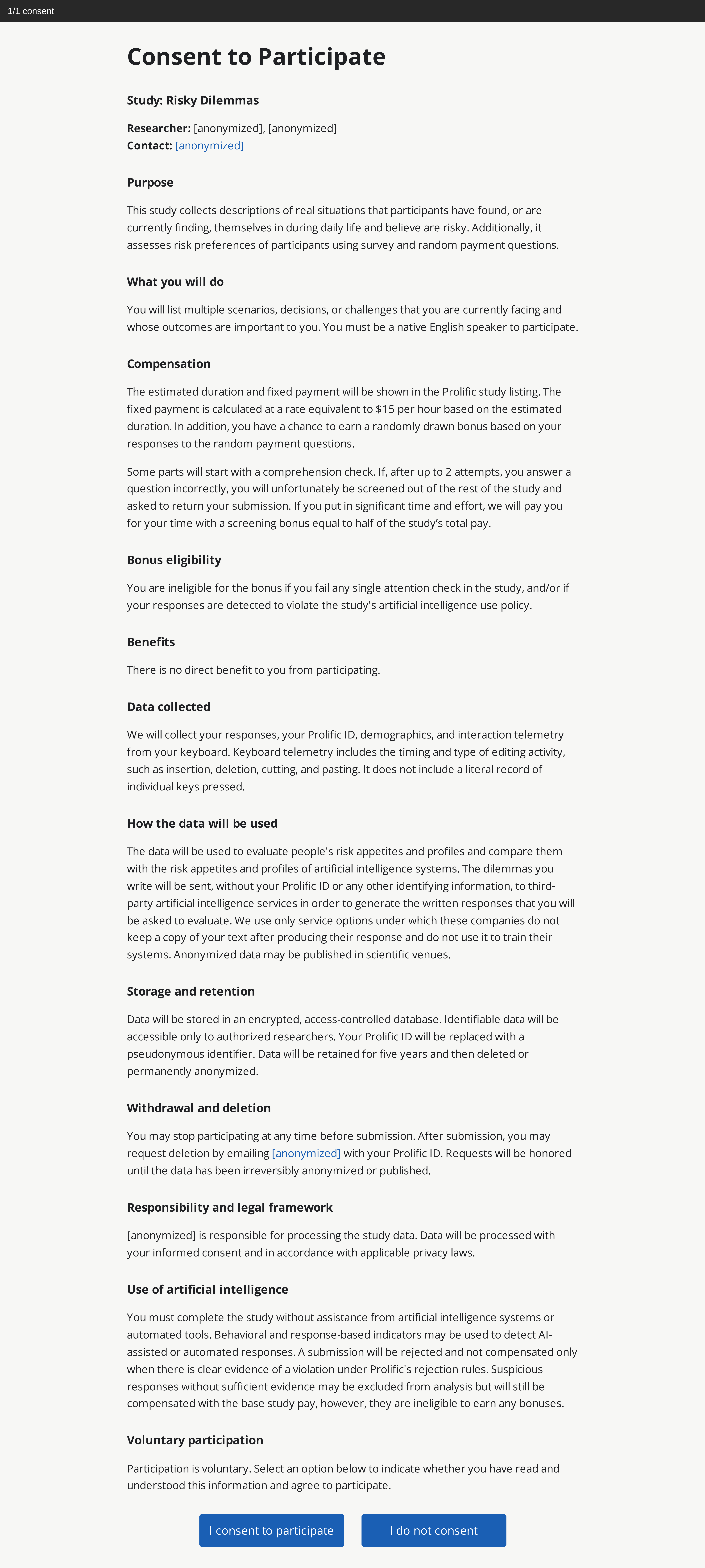


Consent to Participate

Study: Risky Dilemmas

Researcher: [anonymized], [anonymized]
Contact: [anonymized]

Purpose

This study collects descriptions of real situations that participants have found, or are currently finding, themselves in during daily life and believe are risky. Additionally, it assesses risk preferences of participants using survey and random payment questions.

What you will do

You will list multiple scenarios, decisions, or challenges that you are currently facing and whose outcomes are important to you. You must be a native English speaker to participate.

Compensation

The estimated duration and fixed payment will be shown in the Prolific study listing. The fixed payment is calculated at a rate equivalent to $15 per hour based on the estimated duration. In addition, you have a chance to earn a randomly drawn bonus based on your responses to the random payment questions.

Some parts will start with a comprehension check. If, after up to 2 attempts, you answer a question incorrectly, you will unfortunately be screened out of the rest of the study and asked to return your submission. If you put in significant time and effort, we will pay you for your time with a screening bonus equal to half of the study's total pay.

Bonus eligibility

You are ineligible for the bonus if you fail any single attention check in the study, and/or if your responses are detected to violate the study's artificial intelligence use policy.

Benefits

There is no direct benefit to you from participating.

Data collected

We will collect your responses, your Prolific ID, demographics, and interaction telemetry from your keyboard. Keyboard telemetry includes the timing and type of editing activity, such as insertion, deletion, cutting, and pasting. It does not include a literal record of individual keys pressed.

How the data will be used

The data will be used to evaluate people's risk appetites and profiles and compare them with the risk appetites and profiles of artificial intelligence systems. The dilemmas you write will be sent, without your Prolific ID or any other identifying information, to third-party artificial intelligence services in order to generate the written responses that you will be asked to evaluate. We use only service options under which these companies do not keep a copy of your text after producing their response and do not use it to train their systems. Anonymized data may be published in scientific venues.

Storage and retention

Data will be stored in an encrypted, access-controlled database. Identifiable data will be accessible only to authorized researchers. Your Prolific ID will be replaced with a pseudonymous identifier. Data will be retained for five years and then deleted or permanently anonymized.

Withdrawal and deletion

You may stop participating at any time before submission. After submission, you may request deletion by emailing [anonymized] with your Prolific ID. Requests will be honored until the data has been irreversibly anonymized or published.

Responsibility and legal framework

[anonymized] is responsible for processing the study data. Data will be processed with your informed consent and in accordance with applicable privacy laws.

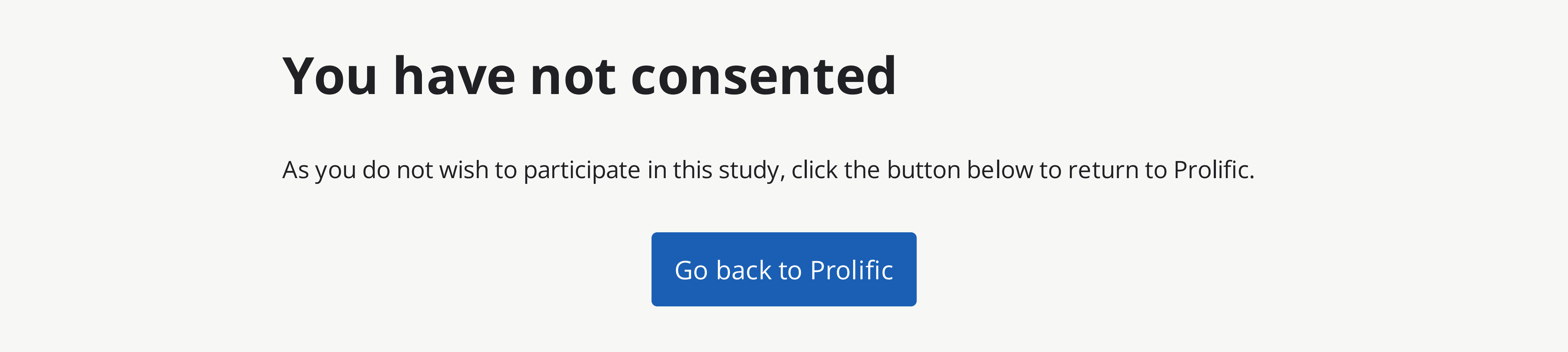
Use of artificial intelligence

You must complete the study without assistance from artificial intelligence systems or automated tools. Behavioral and response-based indicators may be used to detect AI-assisted or automated responses. A submission will be rejected and not compensated only when there is clear evidence of a violation under Prolific's rejection rules. Suspicious responses without sufficient evidence may be excluded from analysis but will still be compensated with the base study pay, however, they are ineligible to earn any bonuses.

Voluntary participation

Participation is voluntary. Select an option below to indicate whether you have read and understood this information and agree to participate.

2/2 consent_declined



You have not consented

As you do not wish to participate in this study, click the button below to return to Prolific.

Go back to Prolific

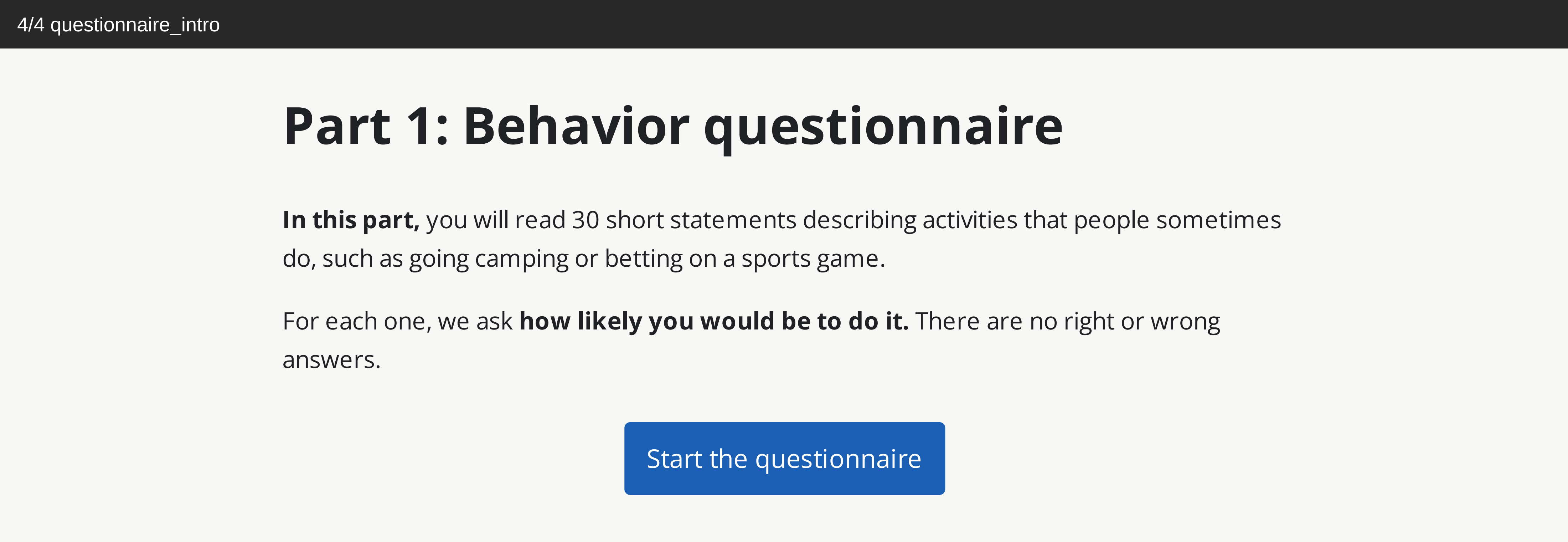
3/3 welcome

Welcome

Thank you for participating in our study. We appreciate you taking the time to help us! This particular study has three parts:

- **Part 1** is a short questionnaire about how likely you would be to engage in various activities.
- **Part 2** asks you to make choices between risky payments.
- **Part 3** asks you to describe risky dilemmas from your own life and then to read and rate two written responses to each of them.

Start Part 1

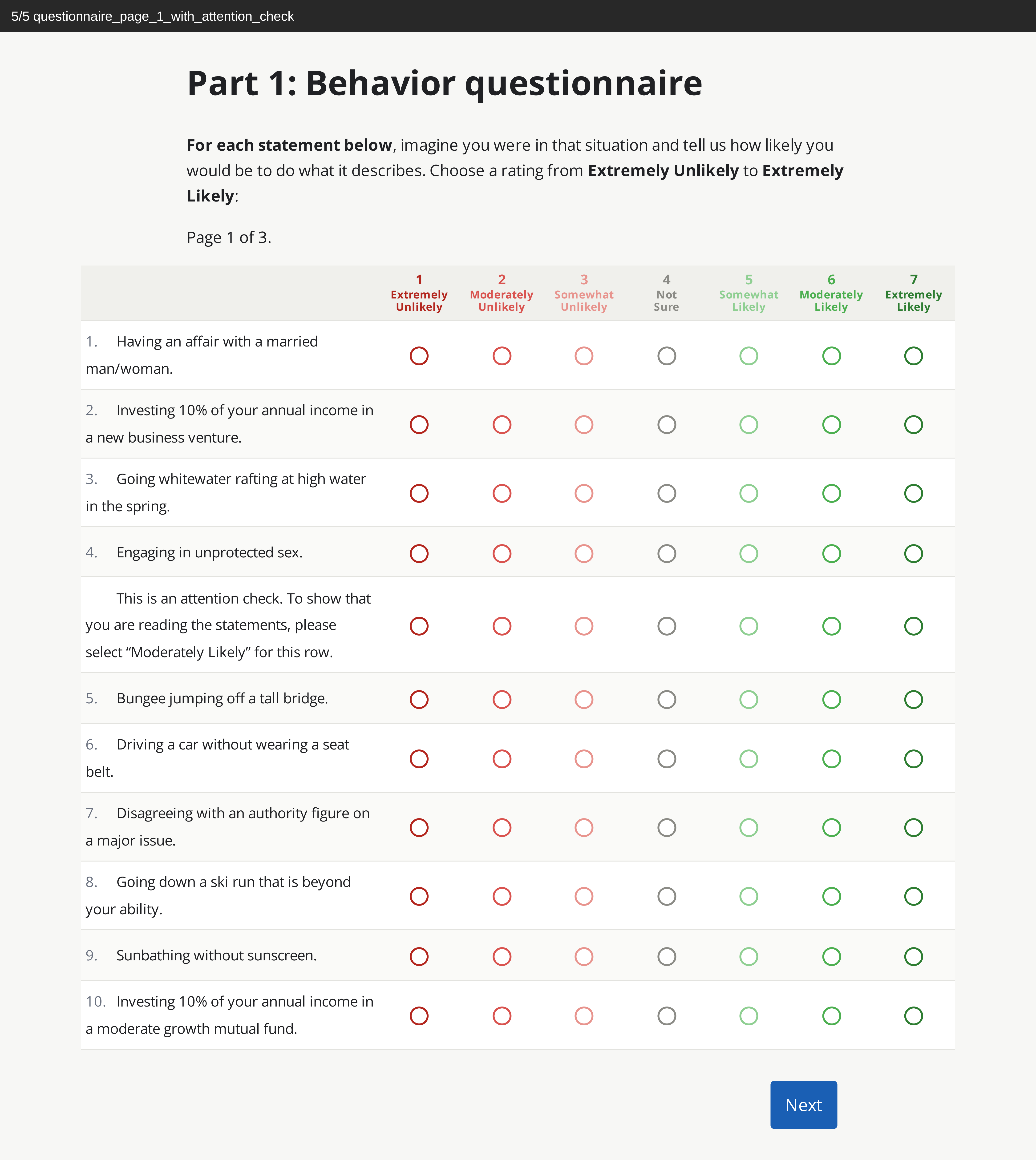

4/4 questionnaire_intro

Part 1: Behavior questionnaire

In this part, you will read 30 short statements describing activities that people sometimes do, such as going camping or betting on a sports game.

For each one, we ask **how likely you would be to do it.** There are no right or wrong answers.

Start the questionnaire



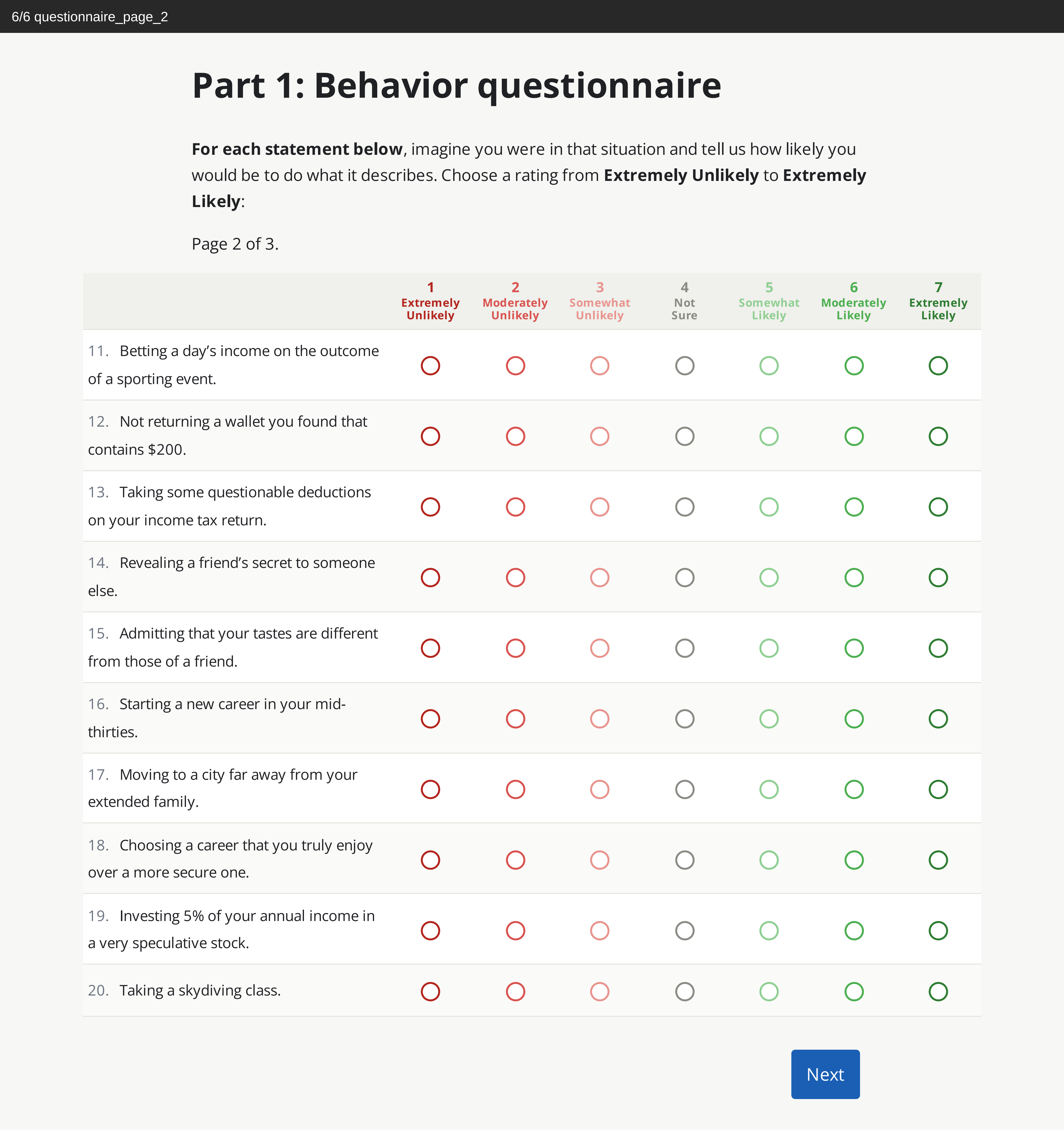
5/5 questionnaire_page_1_with_attention_check

Part 1: Behavior questionnaire

For each statement below, imagine you were in that situation and tell us how likely you would be to do what it describes. Choose a rating from **Extremely Unlikely** to **Extremely Likely**:

Page 1 of 3.

	1 Extremely Unlikely	2 Moderately Unlikely	3 Somewhat Unlikely	4 Not Sure	5 Somewhat Likely	6 Moderately Likely	7 Extremely Likely
1. Having an affair with a married man/woman.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
2. Investing 10% of your annual income in a new business venture.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
3. Going whitewater rafting at high water in the spring.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
4. Engaging in unprotected sex.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
This is an attention check. To show that you are reading the statements, please select “Moderately Likely” for this row.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
5. Bungee jumping off a tall bridge.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
6. Driving a car without wearing a seat belt.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
7. Disagreeing with an authority figure on a major issue.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
8. Going down a ski run that is beyond your ability.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
9. Sunbathing without sunscreen.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
10. Investing 10% of your annual income in a moderate growth mutual fund.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

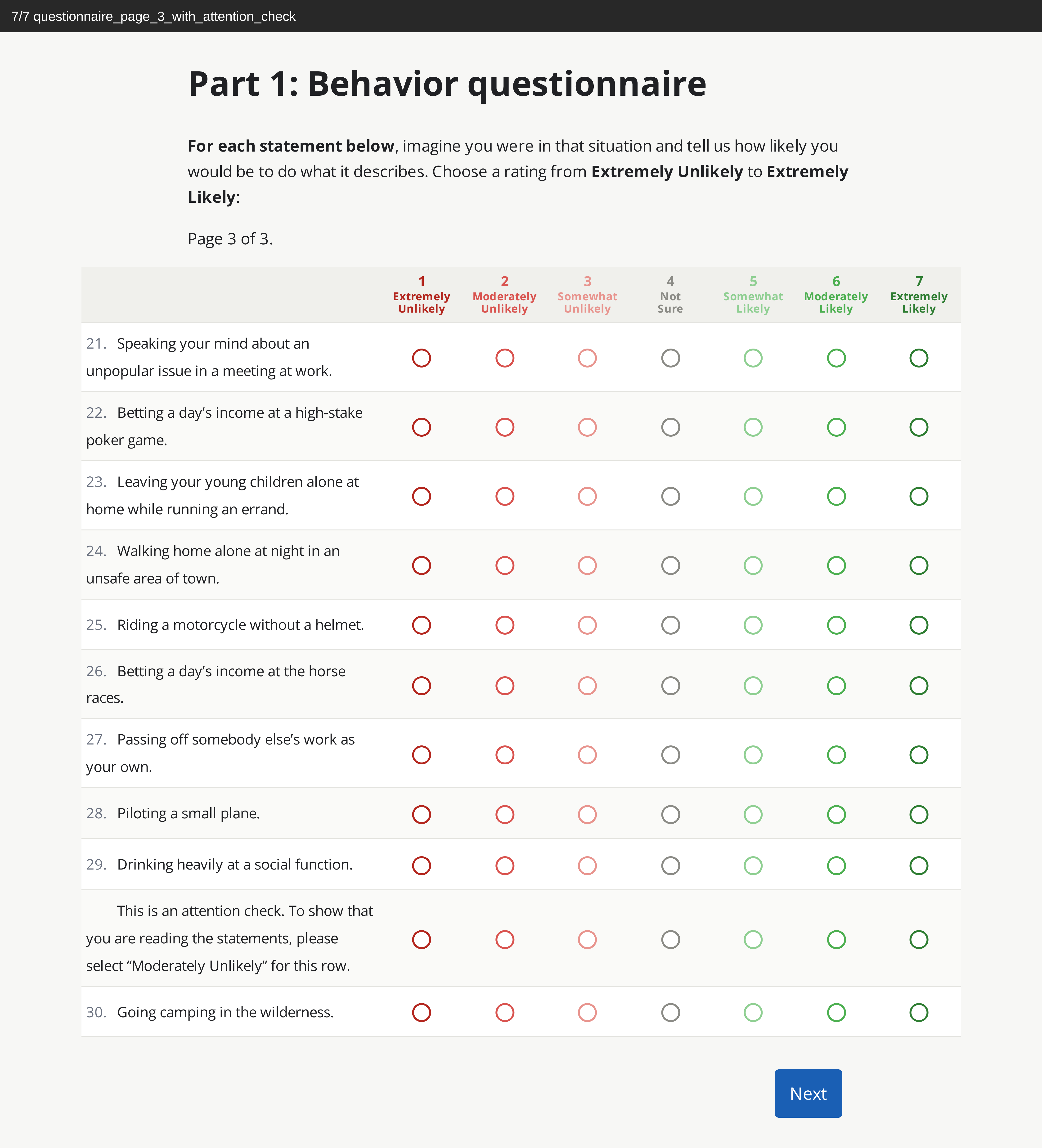


Part 1: Behavior questionnaire

For each statement below, imagine you were in that situation and tell us how likely you would be to do what it describes. Choose a rating from **Extremely Unlikely** to **Extremely Likely**:

Page 2 of 3.

	1 Extremely Unlikely	2 Moderately Unlikely	3 Somewhat Unlikely	4 Not Sure	5 Somewhat Likely	6 Moderately Likely	7 Extremely Likely
11. Betting a day's income on the outcome of a sporting event.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
12. Not returning a wallet you found that contains $200.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
13. Taking some questionable deductions on your income tax return.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
14. Revealing a friend's secret to someone else.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
15. Admitting that your tastes are different from those of a friend.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
16. Starting a new career in your mid-thirties.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
17. Moving to a city far away from your extended family.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
18. Choosing a career that you truly enjoy over a more secure one.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
19. Investing 5% of your annual income in a very speculative stock.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
20. Taking a skydiving class.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○



7/7 questionnaire_page_3_with_attention_check

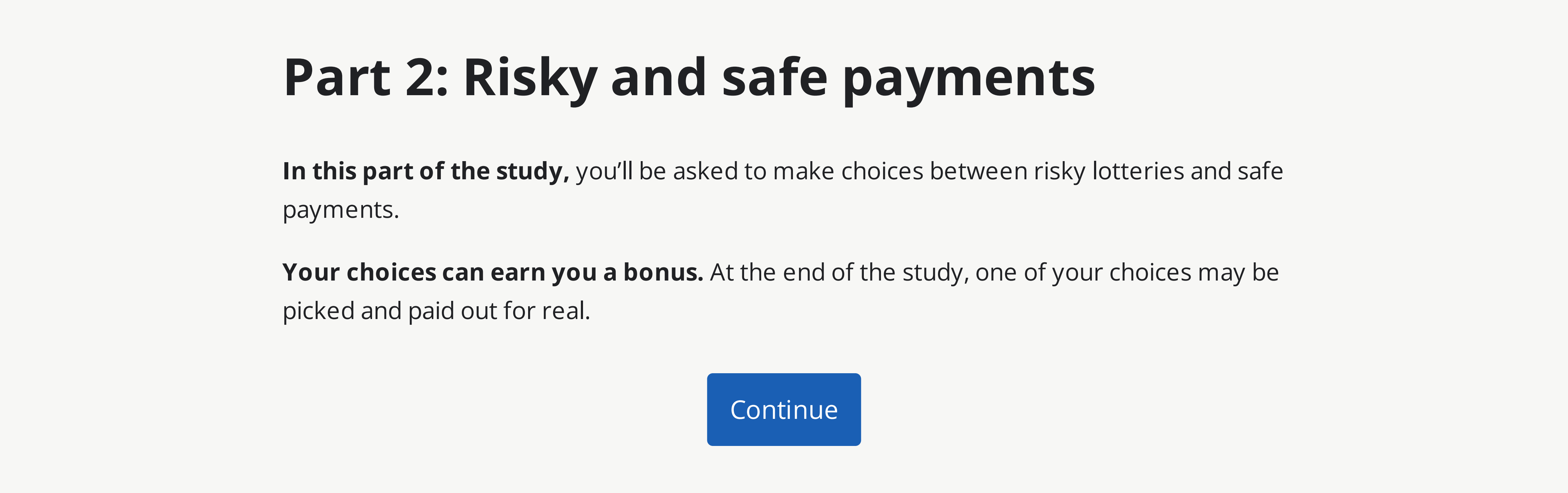
Part 1: Behavior questionnaire

For each statement below, imagine you were in that situation and tell us how likely you would be to do what it describes. Choose a rating from **Extremely Unlikely** to **Extremely Likely**:

Page 3 of 3.

	1 **Extremely Unlikely**	**2** **Moderately Unlikely**	**3** **Somewhat Unlikely**	**4** **Not Sure**	**5** **Somewhat Likely**	**6** **Moderately Likely**	**7** **Extremely Likely**
21. Speaking your mind about an unpopular issue in a meeting at work.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
22. Betting a day's income at a high-stake poker game.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
23. Leaving your young children alone at home while running an errand.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
24. Walking home alone at night in an unsafe area of town.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
25. Riding a motorcycle without a helmet.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
26. Betting a day's income at the horse races.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
27. Passing off somebody else's work as your own.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
28. Piloting a small plane.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
29. Drinking heavily at a social function.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
This is an attention check. To show that you are reading the statements, please select "Moderately Unlikely" for this row.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
30. Going camping in the wilderness.	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

8/8 lottery_part_intro

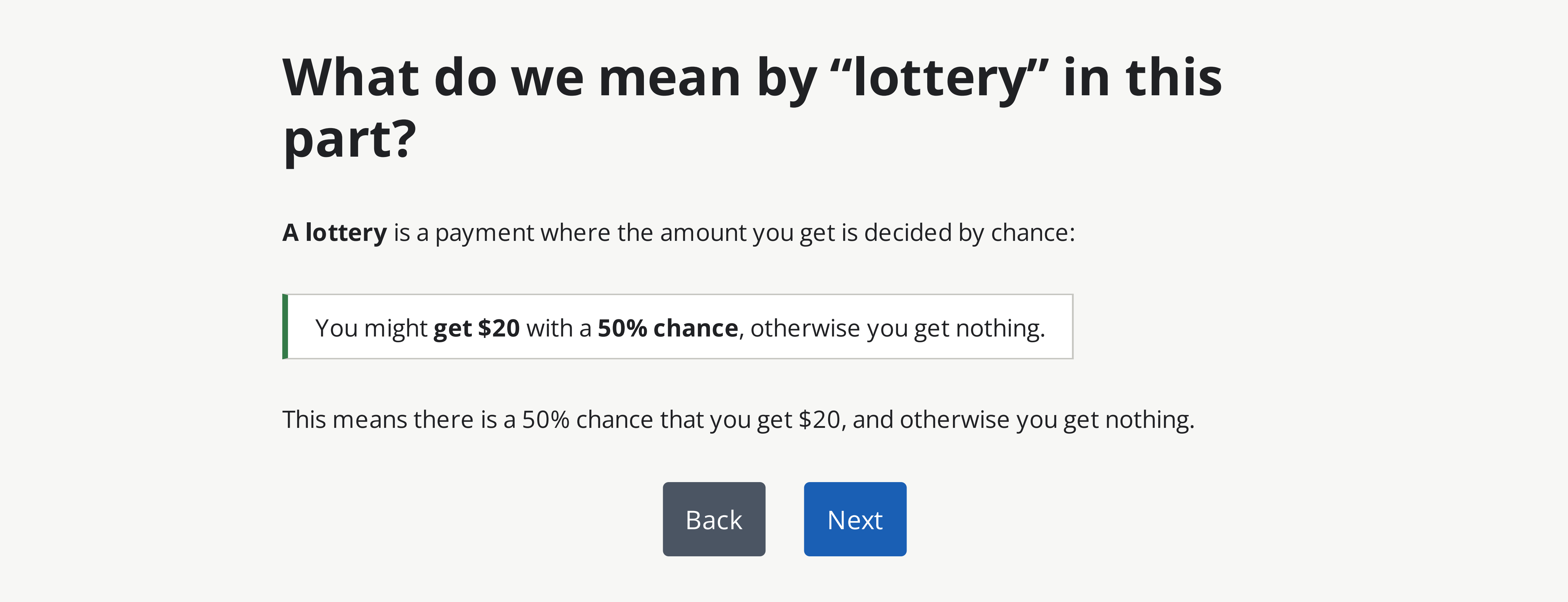


Part 2: Risky and safe payments

In this part of the study, you’ll be asked to make choices between risky lotteries and safe payments.

Your choices can earn you a bonus. At the end of the study, one of your choices may be picked and paid out for real.

9/9 lottery_instructions_1_lotteries



What do we mean by “lottery” in this part?

A lottery is a payment where the amount you get is decided by chance:

> You might **get $20** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.

This means there is a 50% chance that you get $20, and otherwise you get nothing.

What choices will you make in this part?

In this part, we will ask you to make a series of choices between lotteries and guaranteed payments. For example:

Option A		Option B
You might **get $20** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ○	You will certainly **get $9**.

On each page, you'll see a list of choices of this form, one per row. Option A, the lottery, always stays the same, and Option B, the guaranteed payment, gets better as you move down the list.

Option A		Option B
You might **get $20** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $5**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $10**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $15**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $20**.

Overall, **you will be asked to fill out three lists**, with one list displayed per page.

Back Next

Making choices in a lottery list

When you are filling out a list, **you do not have to click a button in each row individually**.

Because **Option B gets better as you move down the list**, to make things easier for you, **the list fills itself in**. If you choose Option A in a row, Option A will also be selected in every row *above it*. If you choose Option B in a row, Option B will also be selected in every row *below it*. You can revise any of your choices before moving on.

Choosing Option A in row 3 also selects Option A in rows 1 and 2.

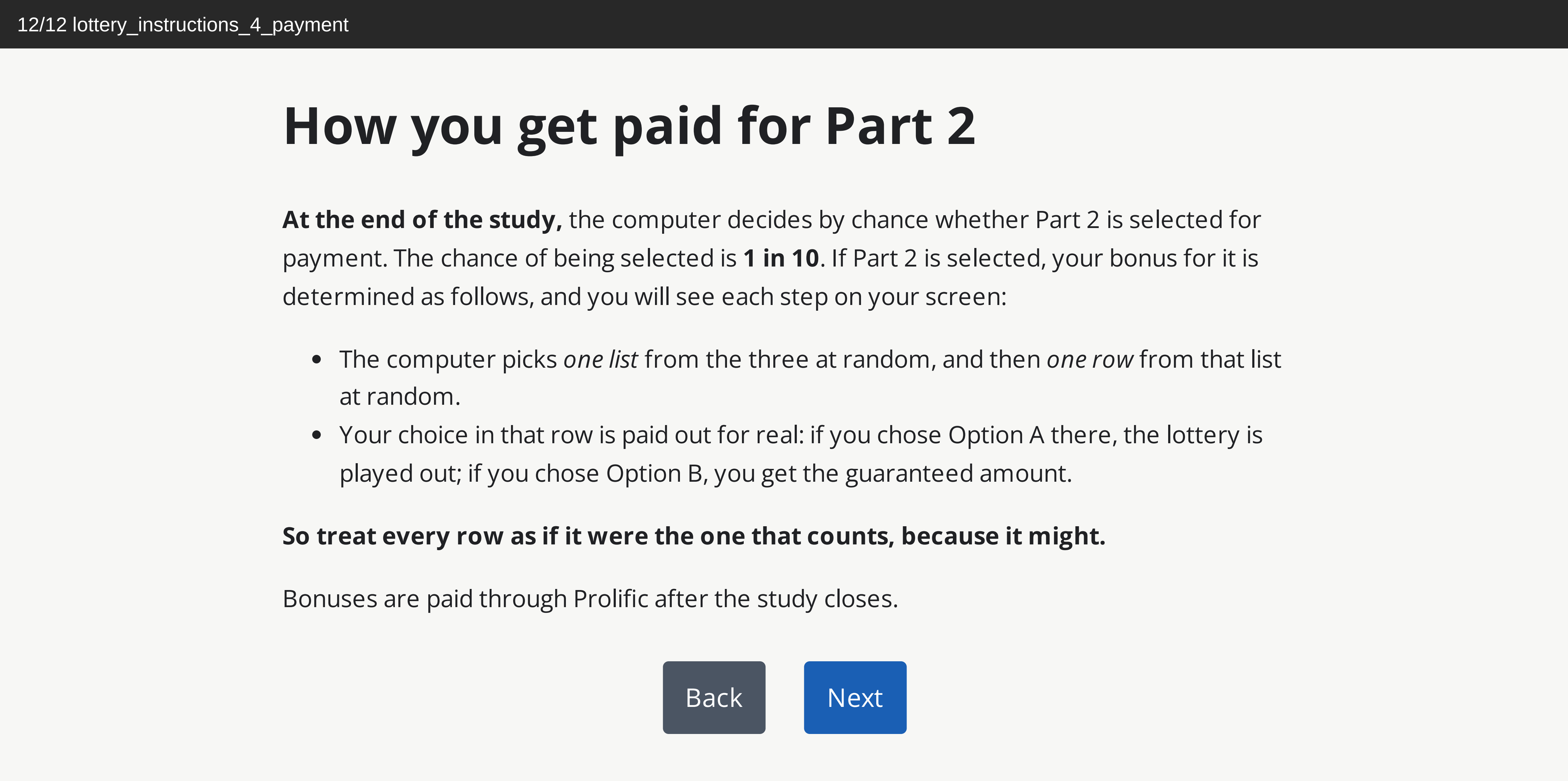
Option A			Option B
You might **get $20** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	●	○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	●	○	You will certainly **get $5**.
	●	○	**You will certainly get $10.**
	○	○	You will certainly **get $15**.
	○	○	You will certainly **get $20**.

At the end of the study, *one row* from *one list* may be randomly selected for payment, and you'll receive the option you selected in that row. So, **consider each row independently of all the other rows**.

There are no right or wrong answers. Which option you pick depends on your personal preferences.

Click "Next" to read about your payment.

Back Next



12/12 lottery_instructions_4_payment

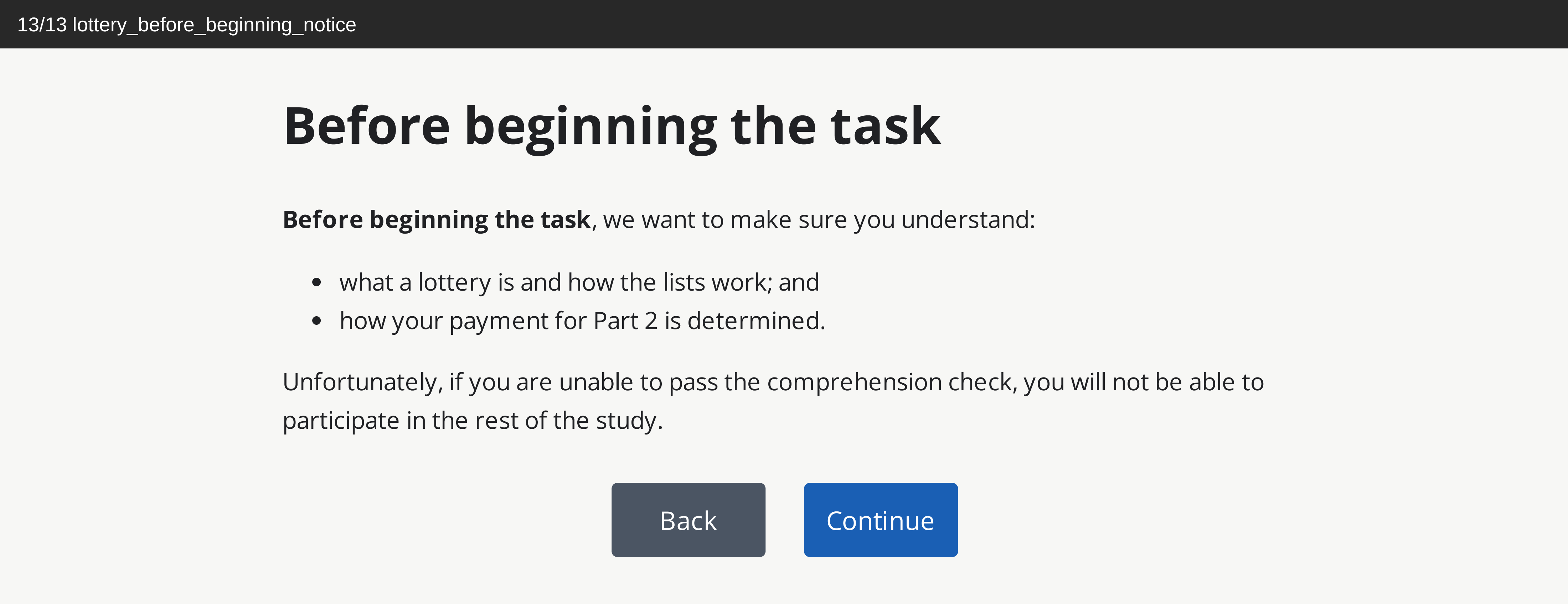
How you get paid for Part 2

At the end of the study, the computer decides by chance whether Part 2 is selected for payment. The chance of being selected is **1 in 10**. If Part 2 is selected, your bonus for it is determined as follows, and you will see each step on your screen:

- The computer picks *one list* from the three at random, and then *one row* from that list at random.
- Your choice in that row is paid out for real: if you chose Option A there, the lottery is played out; if you chose Option B, you get the guaranteed amount.

So treat every row as if it were the one that counts, because it might.

Bonuses are paid through Prolific after the study closes.



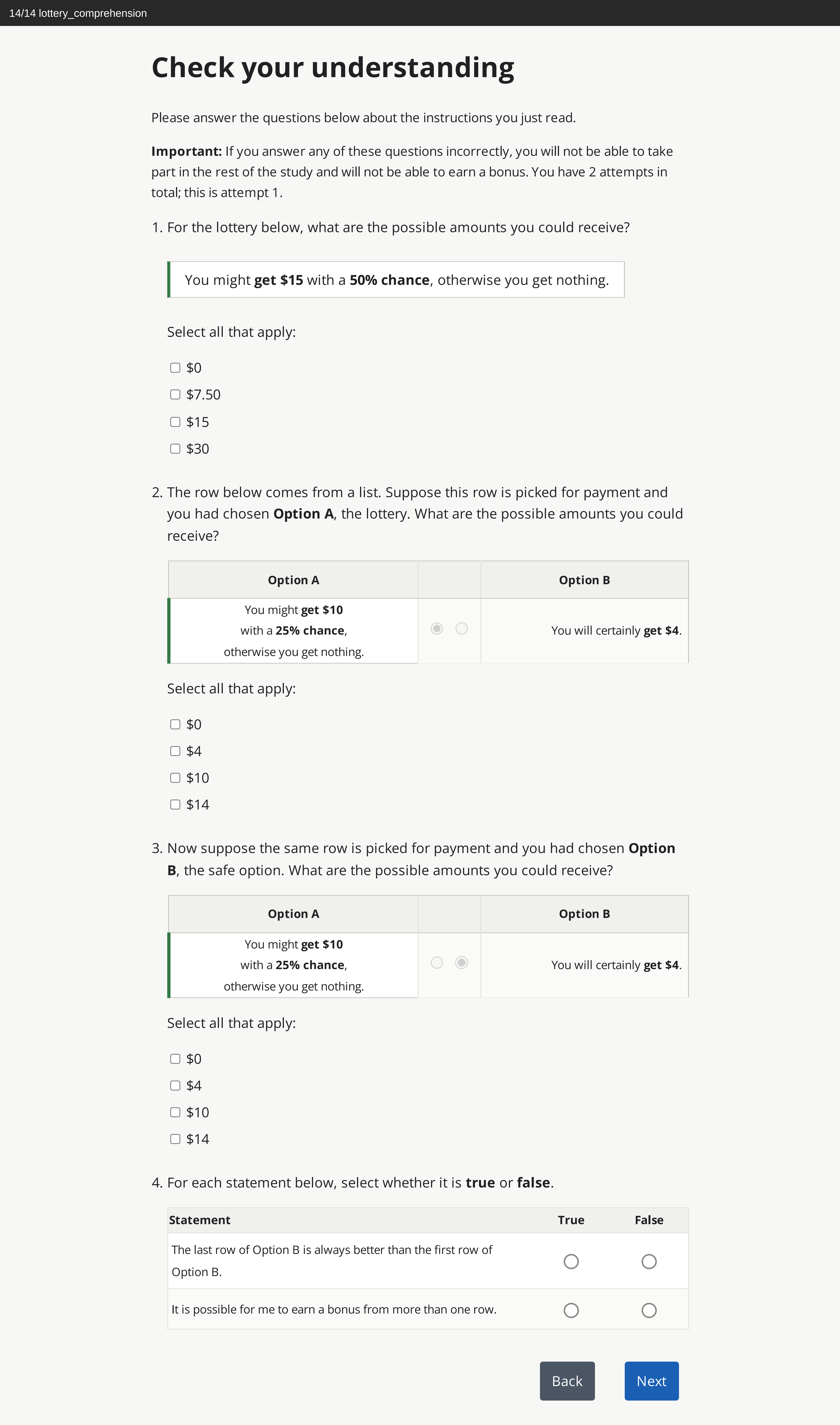
13/13 lottery_before_beginning_notice

Before beginning the task

Before beginning the task, we want to make sure you understand:

- what a lottery is and how the lists work; and
- how your payment for Part 2 is determined.

Unfortunately, if you are unable to pass the comprehension check, you will not be able to participate in the rest of the study.



Check your understanding

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

1. For the lottery below, what are the possible amounts you could receive?

> You might **get $15** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.

Select all that apply:

☐ $0
☐ $7.50
☐ $15
☐ $30

2. The row below comes from a list. Suppose this row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option A**, the lottery. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get $4**.

Select all that apply:

☐ $0
☐ $4
☐ $10
☐ $14

3. Now suppose the same row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option B**, the safe option. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.

Select all that apply:

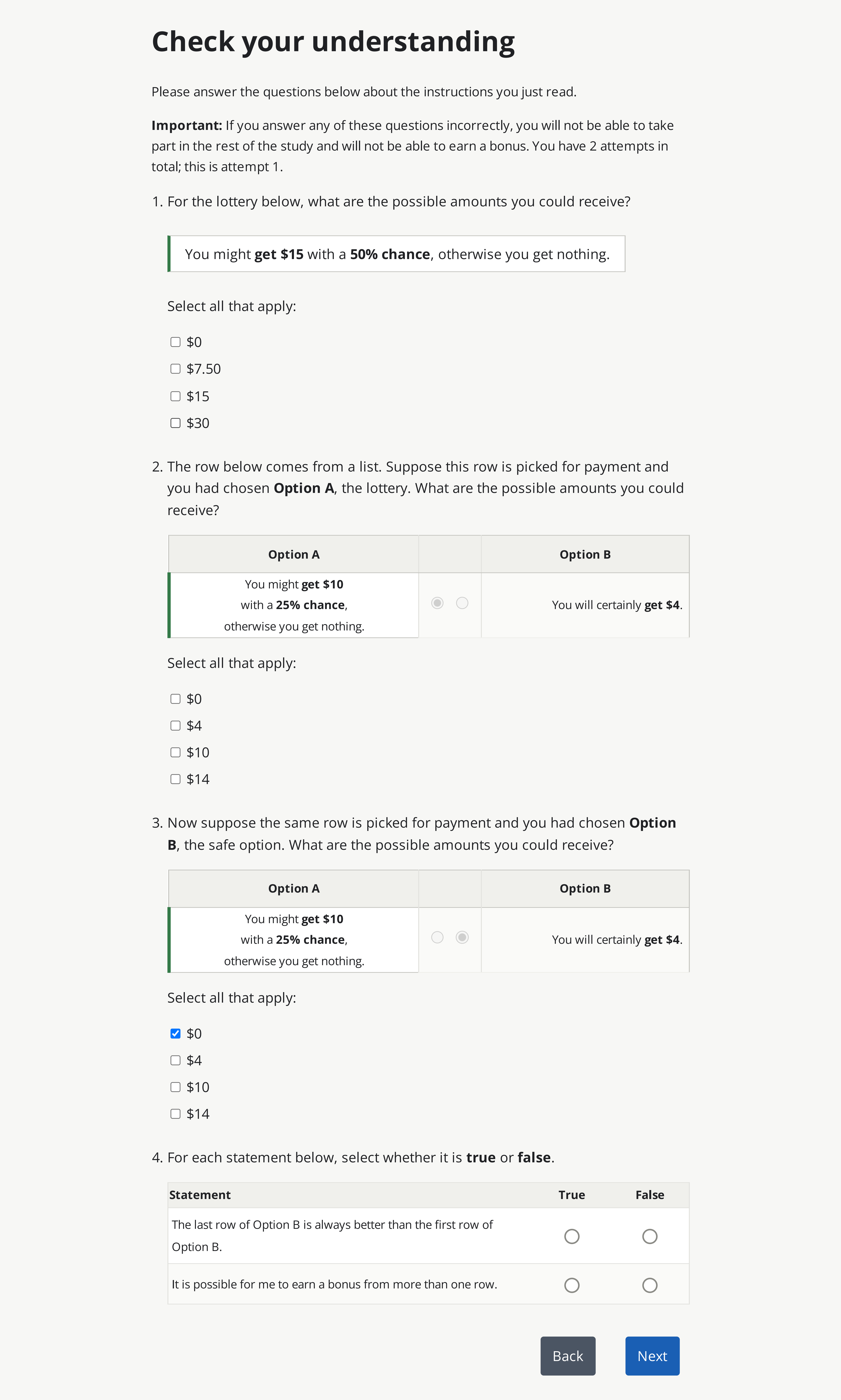
☐ $0
☐ $4
☐ $10
☐ $14

4. For each statement below, select whether it is **true** or **false**.

Statement	True	False
The last row of Option B is always better than the first row of Option B.	○	○
It is possible for me to earn a bonus from more than one row.	○	○

Back Next

15/15 lottery_comprehension_selection_kept_after_back



Check your understanding

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

1. For the lottery below, what are the possible amounts you could receive?

> You might **get $15** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.

Select all that apply:

☐ $0
☐ $7.50
☐ $15
☐ $30

2. The row below comes from a list. Suppose this row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option A**, the lottery. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get $4**.

Select all that apply:

☐ $0
☐ $4
☐ $10
☐ $14

3. Now suppose the same row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option B**, the safe option. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.

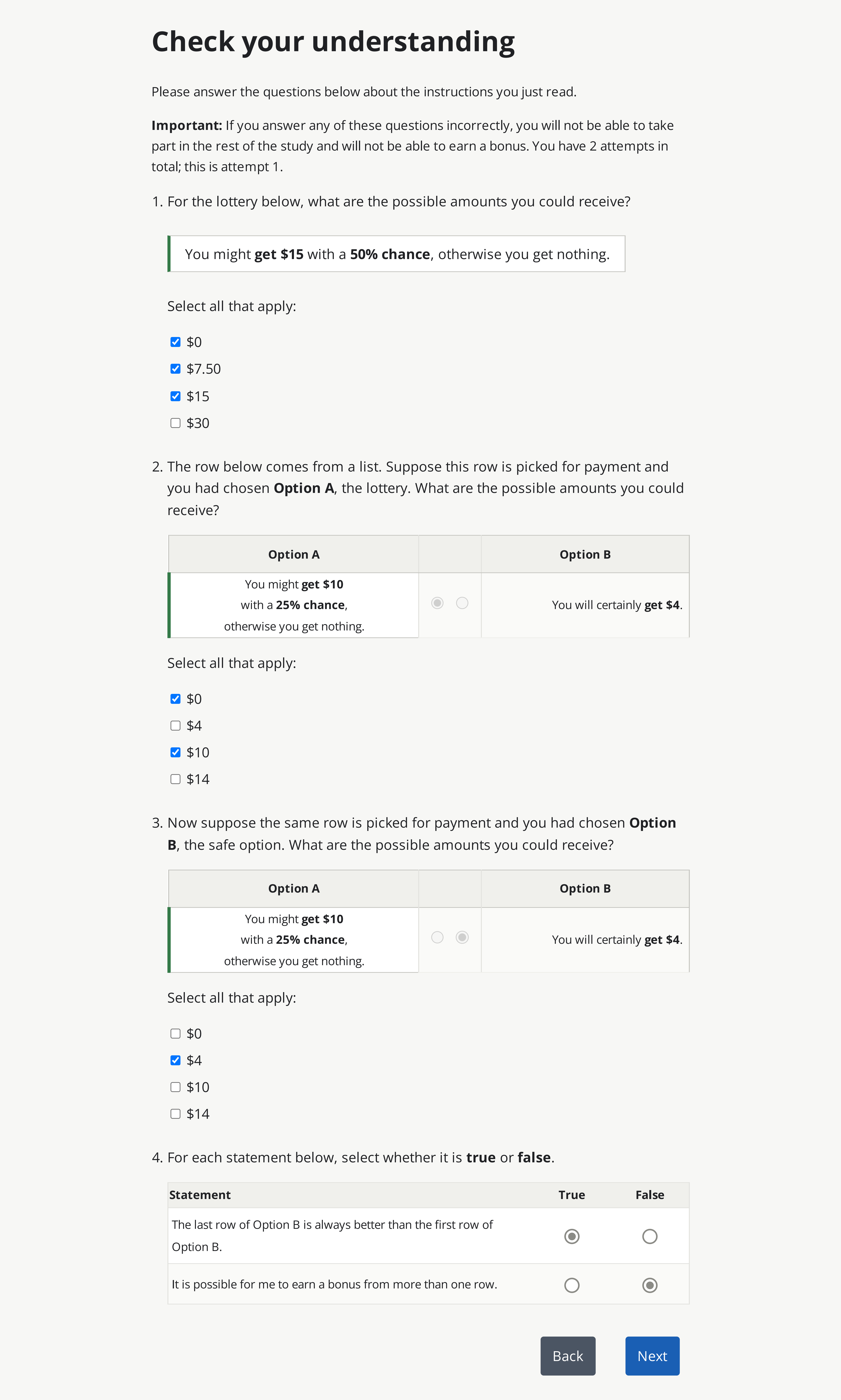
Select all that apply:

☑ $0
☐ $4
☐ $10
☐ $14

4. For each statement below, select whether it is **true** or **false**.

Statement	True	False
The last row of Option B is always better than the first row of Option B.	○	○
It is possible for me to earn a bonus from more than one row.	○	○

16/16 lottery_comprehension_filled



Check your understanding

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

1. For the lottery below, what are the possible amounts you could receive?

> You might **get $15** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.

Select all that apply:

☑ $0
☑ $7.50
☑ $15
☐ $30

2. The row below comes from a list. Suppose this row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option A**, the lottery. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get $4**.

Select all that apply:

☑ $0
☐ $4
☑ $10
☐ $14

3. Now suppose the same row is picked for payment and you had chosen **Option B**, the safe option. What are the possible amounts you could receive?

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.

Select all that apply:

☐ $0
☑ $4
☐ $10
☐ $14

4. For each statement below, select whether it is **true** or **false**.

Statement	**True**	**False**
The last row of Option B is always better than the first row of Option B.	●	○
It is possible for me to earn a bonus from more than one row.	○	●

Back Next

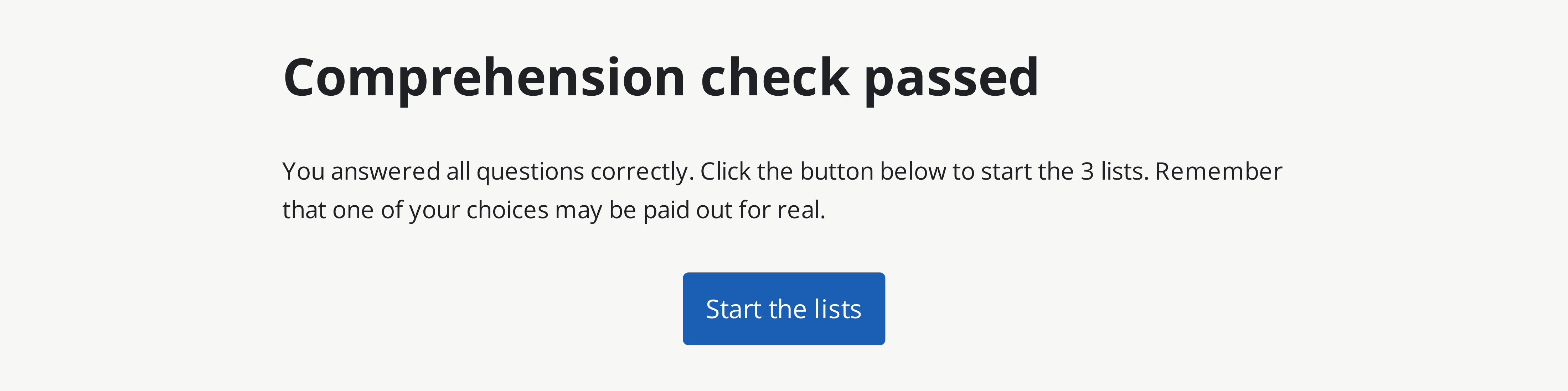
Not all answers were correct

At least one of your answers was incorrect.

You have 1 more attempt. You will now go back to the Part 2 instructions so that you can read them again.

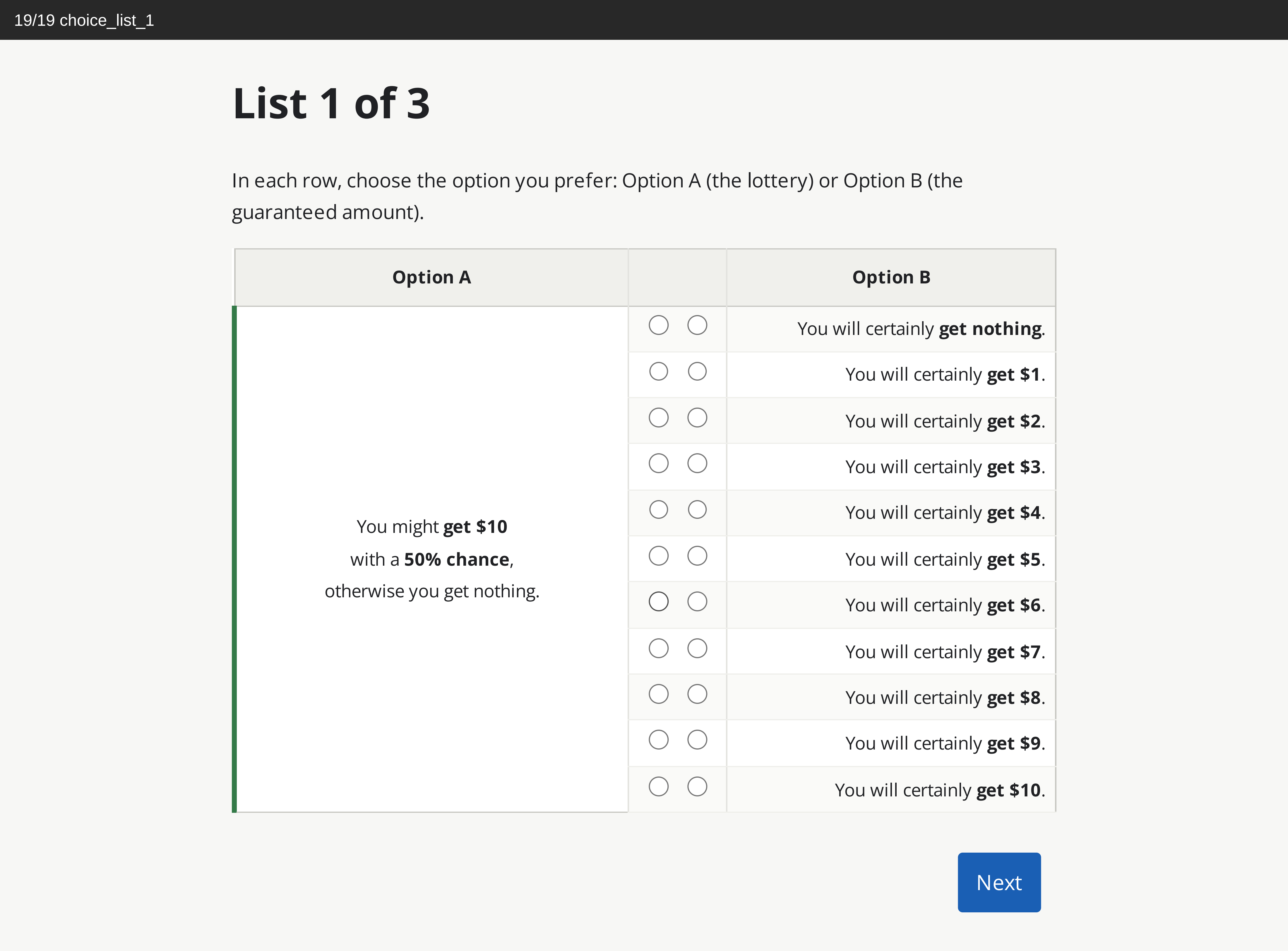
Review the instructions

18/18 lottery_comprehension_passed



Comprehension check passed

You answered all questions correctly. Click the button below to start the 3 lists. Remember that one of your choices may be paid out for real.

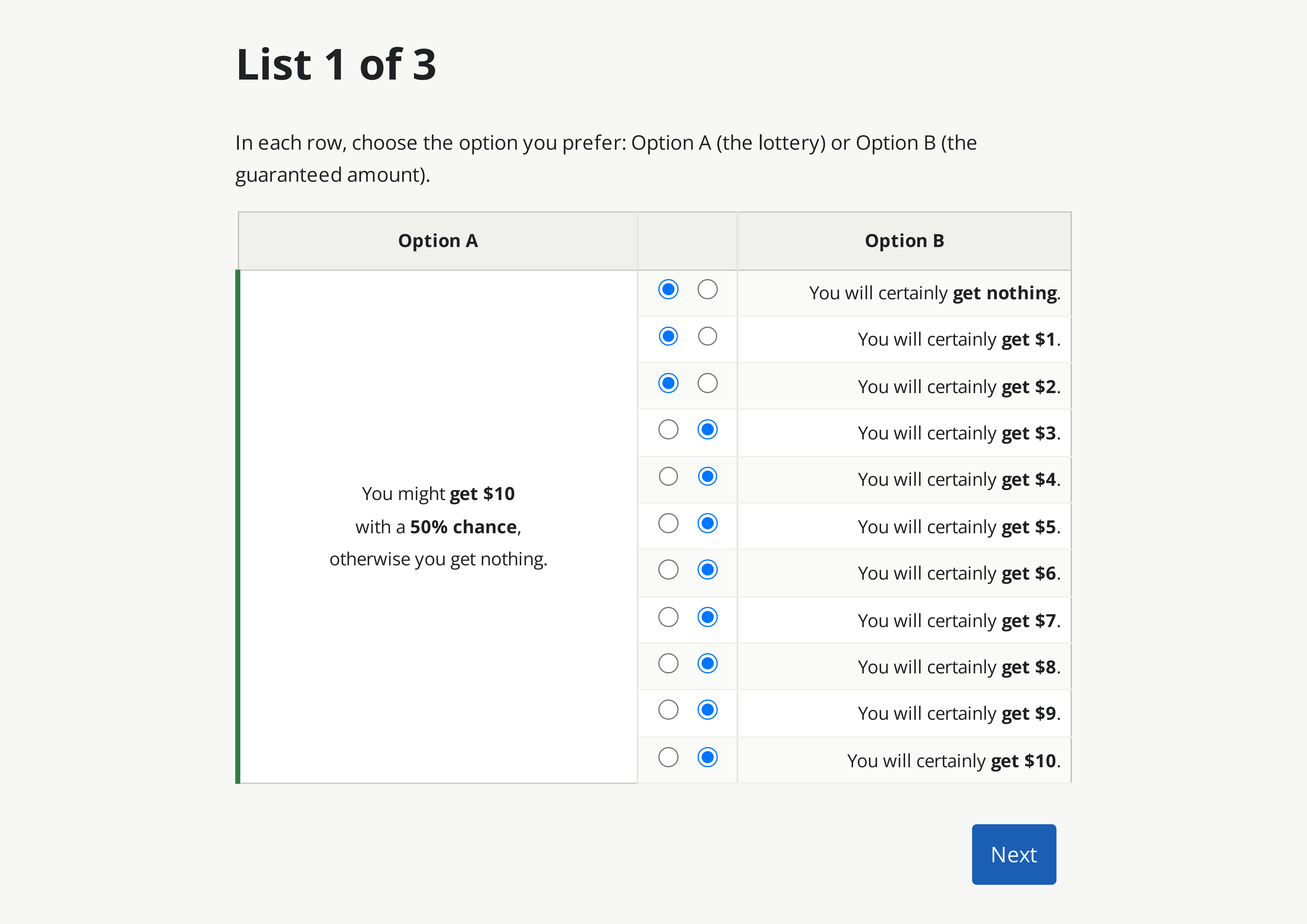


19/19 choice_list_1

List 1 of 3

In each row, choose the option you prefer: Option A (the lottery) or Option B (the guaranteed amount).

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $10**.



List 1 of 3

In each row, choose the option you prefer: Option A (the lottery) or Option B (the guaranteed amount).

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $10**.

List 2 of 3

In each row, choose the option you prefer: Option A (the lottery) or Option B (the guaranteed amount).

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **75% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $10**.

Next

List 3 of 3

In each row, choose the option you prefer: Option A (the lottery) or Option B (the guaranteed amount).

Option A		**Option B**
You might **get $10** with a **25% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	○ ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ○	You will certainly **get $10**.

Next

Part 3: Risky dilemmas

In this part, we are interested in the real dilemmas people face when an important outcome is uncertain and at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

A risky dilemma may involve a choice, a decision, or a challenge in which different actions could lead to meaningfully different outcomes, and at least one outcome carries *some risk*.

Your job is to generate **two examples** of dilemmas *you are currently experiencing* in your own life. They may come from any area of life, including relationships, social situations, work or education, finances, health, or another area that matters to you.

After you have described your dilemmas, you will read **two written responses** to each of them and tell us what you think of the responses.

A note on privacy

Some dilemmas may involve personal or sensitive experiences. Share only what you are comfortable providing. Do not include real people's names, exact addresses, employer names, account information, or other details that could identify you or another person. You may change or generalize identifying details while preserving the substance of the dilemma. You may choose a different situation at any time.

Continue

What counts as a risky dilemma in this study?

An informative risky dilemma should describe:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

Examples that count as risky dilemmas

> "I found a small house to rent next to the landlord's home, but the rent is more than I can comfortably afford. I am considering offering regular help with cleaning, landscaping, cars, and pets in exchange for lower rent. The house would suit my work-from-home job well, but I am uncertain whether to propose such a personal arrangement and whether it would be sustainable."

> "I want to change jobs, but my current contract requires six months' notice and my employer will not shorten it. Prospective employers do not want to wait that long. I am considering resigning before securing another position so that I can interview near the end of my notice period, but doing so would leave me without a guaranteed income or job."

> "My home loan is divided into two equal parts. For each part, I can keep a variable interest rate that resets every three months or select a lower fixed rate for one or two years. Rates are expected to decline gradually, so fixing now could provide certainty and immediate savings but might cost more if variable rates fall. I need to decide how to allocate the two parts while balancing predictability against long-term cost."

Examples that do not yet describe a risky dilemma

> "I had to make an important decision."
>
> This is too vague: it does not explain the choice, why it mattered, or what made the outcome uncertain.

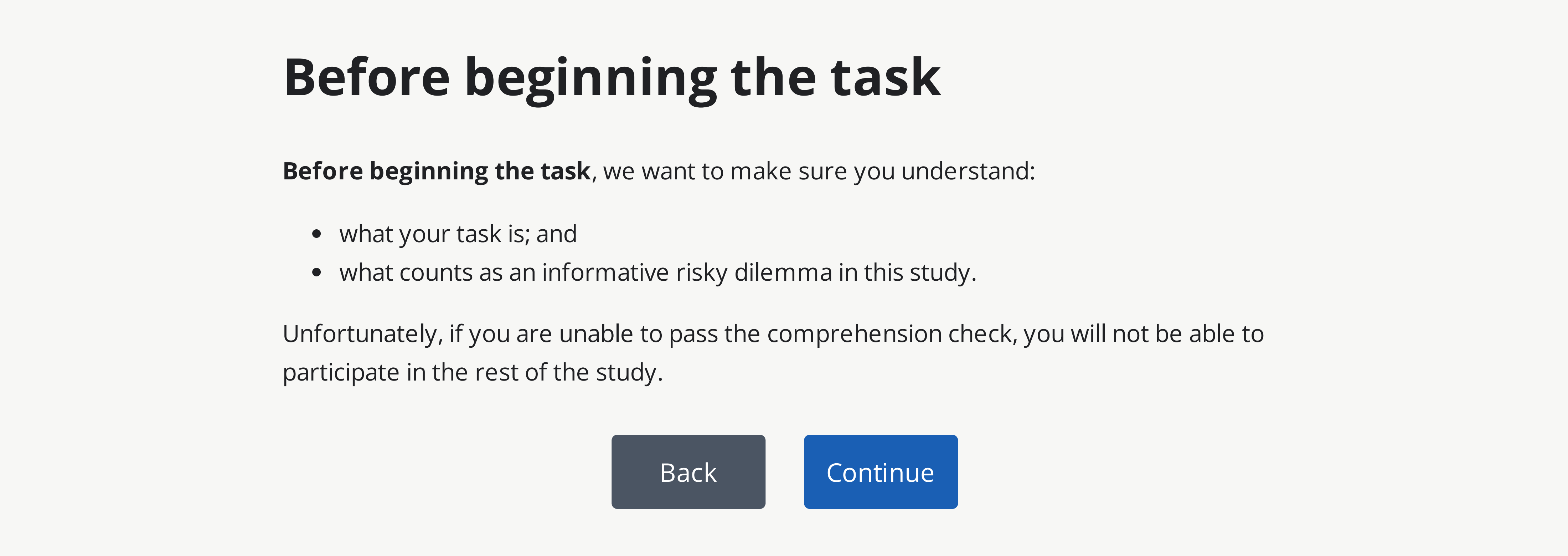
> "I was deciding whether to have tea or coffee with breakfast."
>
> This describes a choice, but not one with a meaningful uncertain outcome or any risk to you or another person.

> "Imagine someone who has to decide whether to move to another country for a new job."
>
> This could be a dilemma, but it is hypothetical rather than a real situation from the participant's own life.

There are no right or wrong kinds of dilemmas, **only informative risky dilemmas that meet the criteria above or not**. We are interested in your own experiences, expressed in your own words.

Back Continue

25/25 dilemma_before_beginning_notice

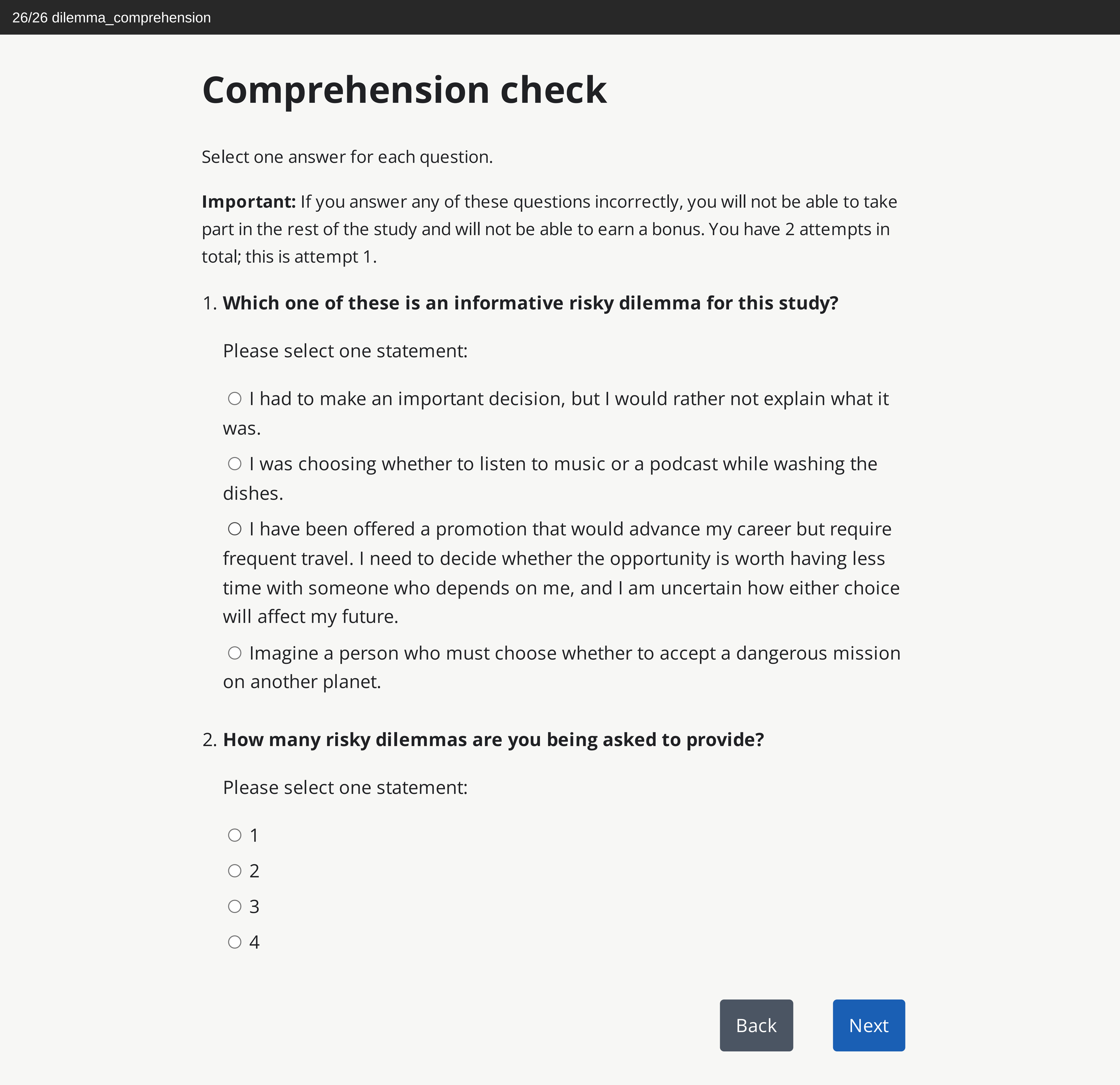


Before beginning the task

Before beginning the task, we want to make sure you understand:

- what your task is; and
- what counts as an informative risky dilemma in this study.

Unfortunately, if you are unable to pass the comprehension check, you will not be able to participate in the rest of the study.



Comprehension check

Select one answer for each question.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

1. **Which one of these is an informative risky dilemma for this study?**

Please select one statement:

○ I had to make an important decision, but I would rather not explain what it was.

○ I was choosing whether to listen to music or a podcast while washing the dishes.

○ I have been offered a promotion that would advance my career but require frequent travel. I need to decide whether the opportunity is worth having less time with someone who depends on me, and I am uncertain how either choice will affect my future.

○ Imagine a person who must choose whether to accept a dangerous mission on another planet.

2. **How many risky dilemmas are you being asked to provide?**

Please select one statement:

○ 1
○ 2
○ 3
○ 4

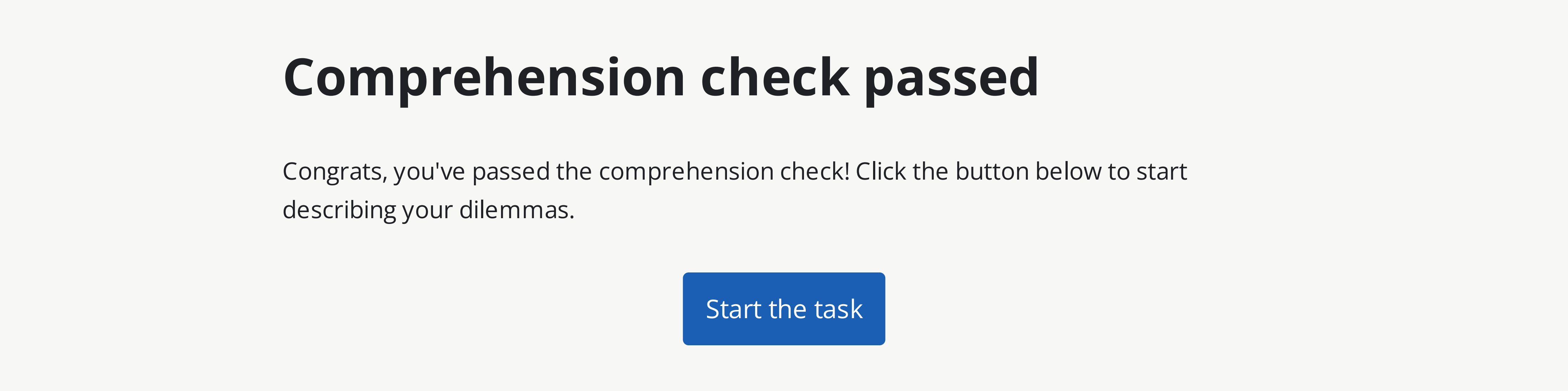
Not all answers were correct

At least one of your answers was incorrect.

You have 1 more attempt. You will now go back to the Part 3 instructions so that you can read them again.

Review the instructions

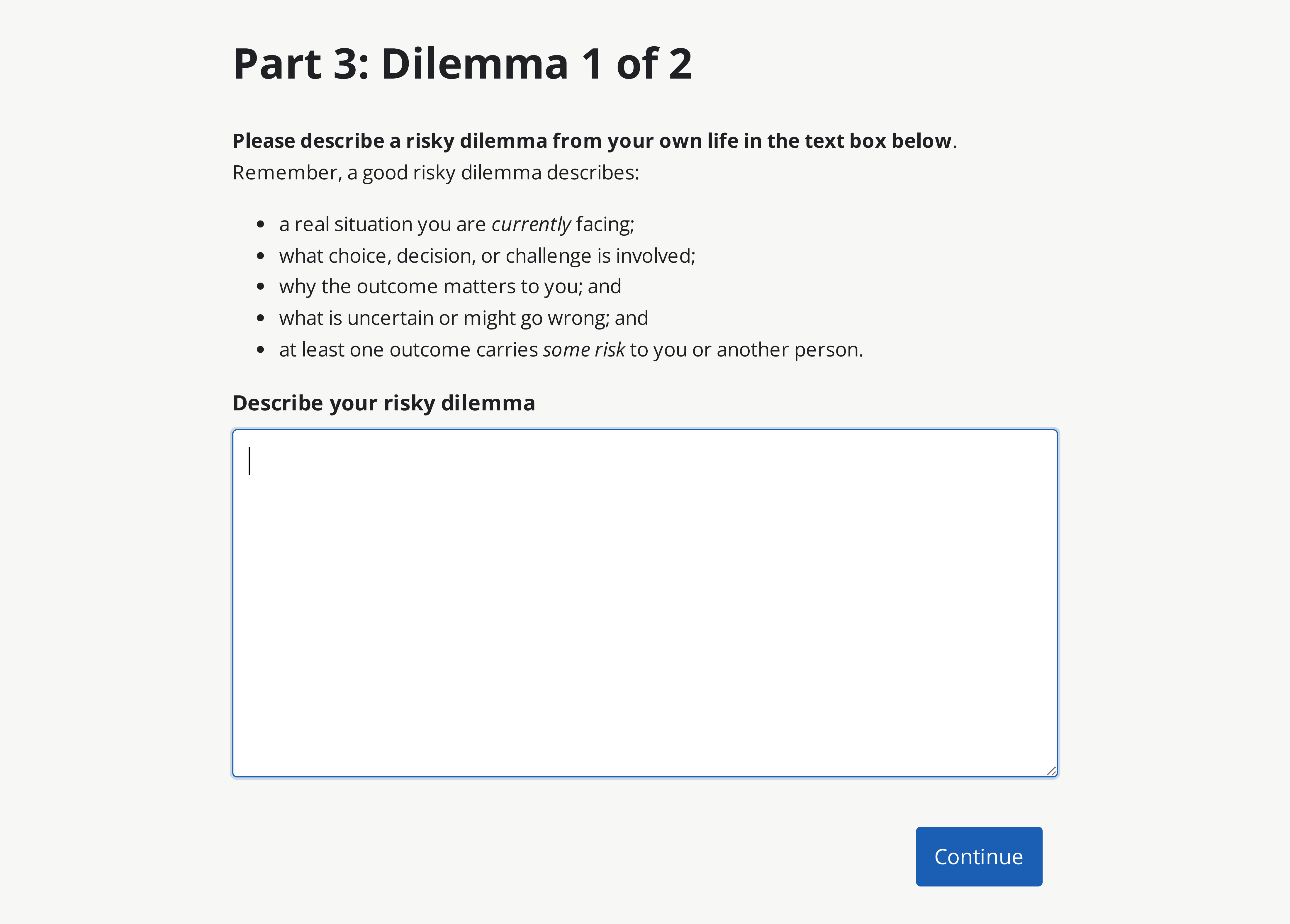
28/28 dilemma_comprehension_passed



Comprehension check passed

Congrats, you've passed the comprehension check! Click the button below to start describing your dilemmas.

29/29 dilemma_1_empty



Part 3: Dilemma 1 of 2

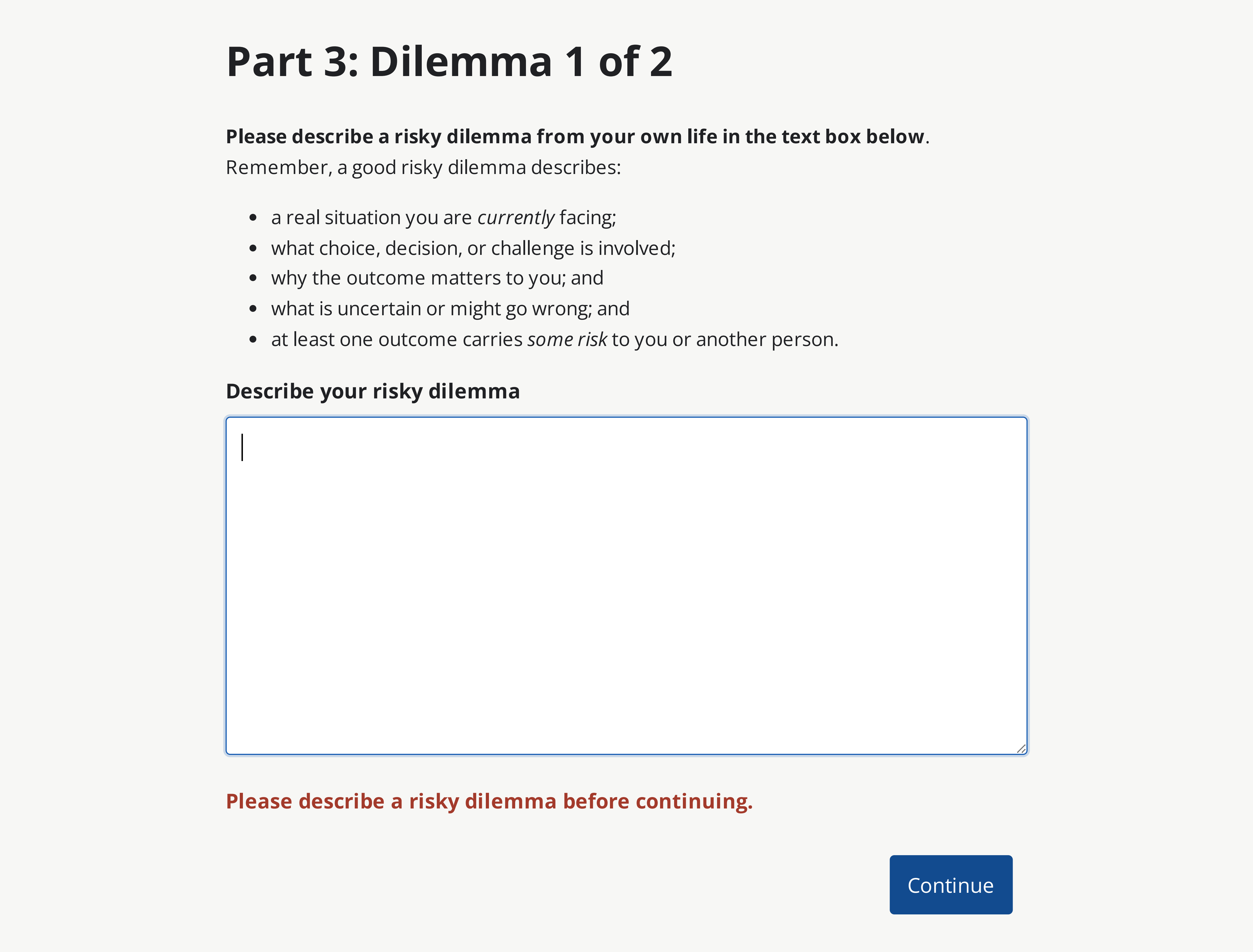
Please describe a risky dilemma from your own life in the text box below.

Remember, a good risky dilemma describes:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

Describe your risky dilemma

30/30 dilemma_1_error_empty_submission



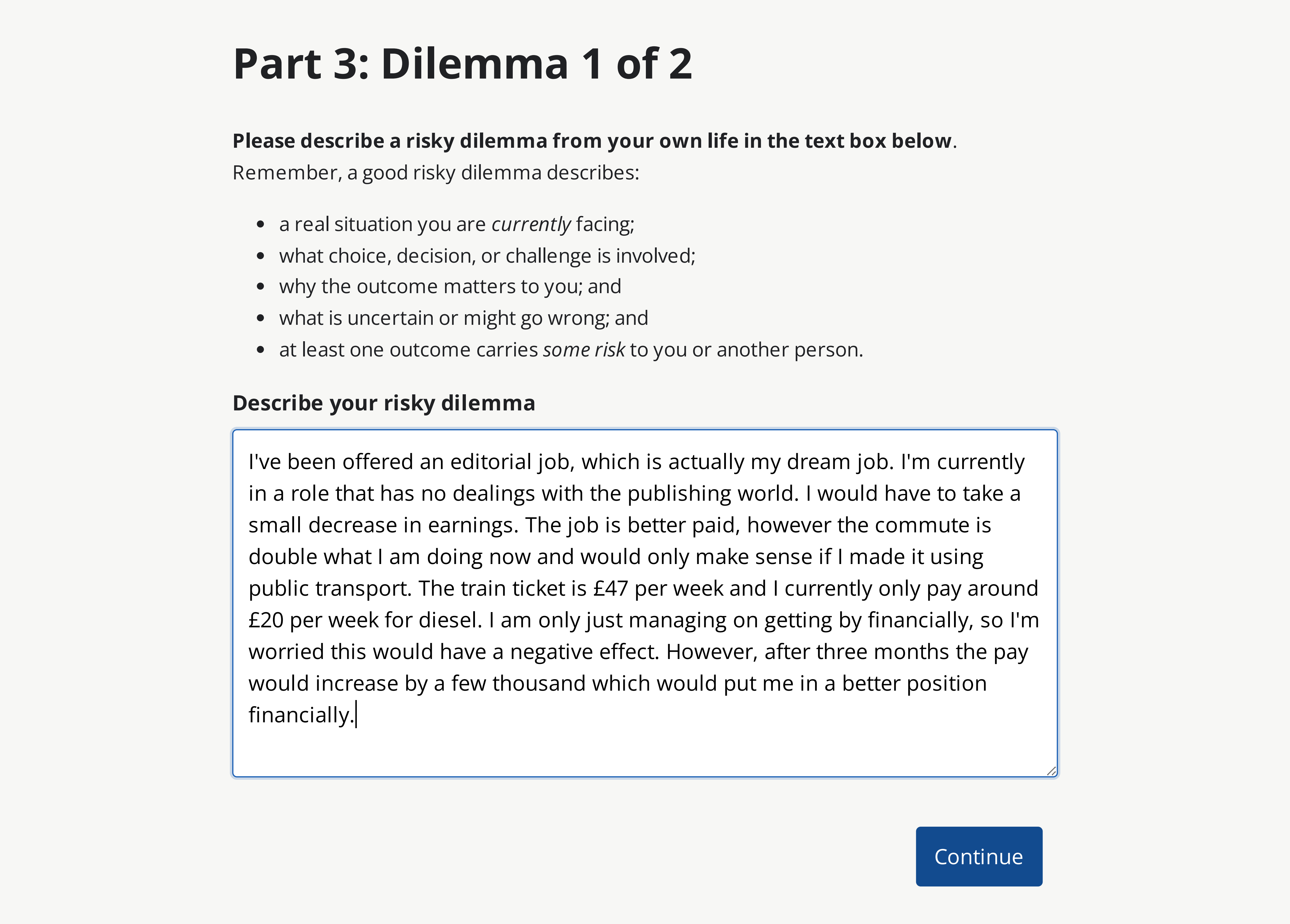
Part 3: Dilemma 1 of 2

Please describe a risky dilemma from your own life in the text box below.
Remember, a good risky dilemma describes:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

Describe your risky dilemma

Please describe a risky dilemma before continuing.



Part 3: Dilemma 1 of 2

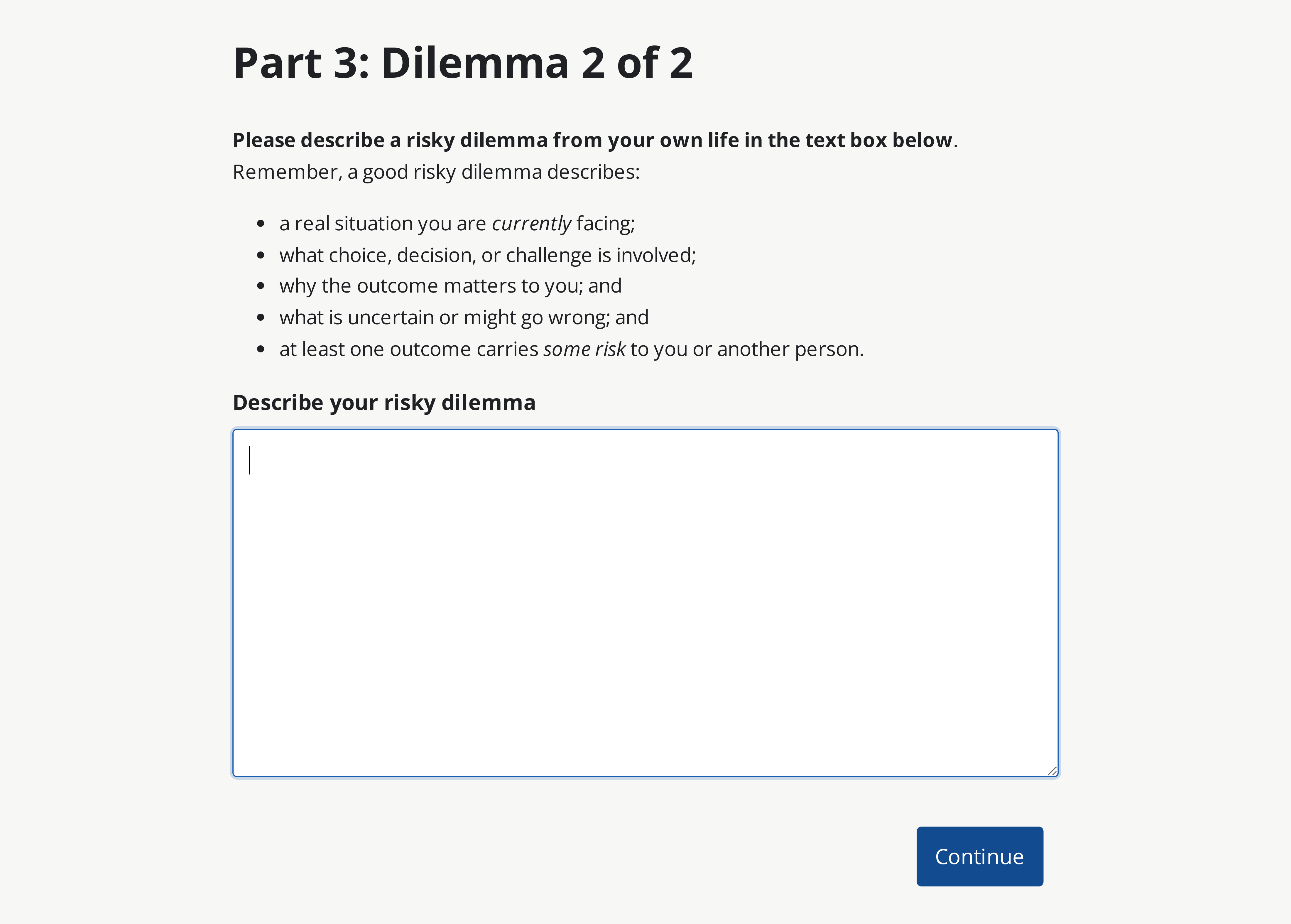
Please describe a risky dilemma from your own life in the text box below.
Remember, a good risky dilemma describes:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

Describe your risky dilemma

I've been offered an editorial job, which is actually my dream job. I'm currently in a role that has no dealings with the publishing world. I would have to take a small decrease in earnings. The job is better paid, however the commute is double what I am doing now and would only make sense if I made it using public transport. The train ticket is £47 per week and I currently only pay around £20 per week for diesel. I am only just managing on getting by financially, so I'm worried this would have a negative effect. However, after three months the pay would increase by a few thousand which would put me in a better position financially.

32/32 dilemma_2_empty



Part 3: Dilemma 2 of 2

Please describe a risky dilemma from your own life in the text box below.

Remember, a good risky dilemma describes:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

Describe your risky dilemma

Part 3: Dilemma 2 of 2

Please describe a risky dilemma from your own life in the text box below.

Remember, a good risky dilemma describes:

- a real situation you are *currently* facing;
- what choice, decision, or challenge is involved;
- why the outcome matters to you; and
- what is uncertain or might go wrong; and
- at least one outcome carries *some risk* to you or another person.

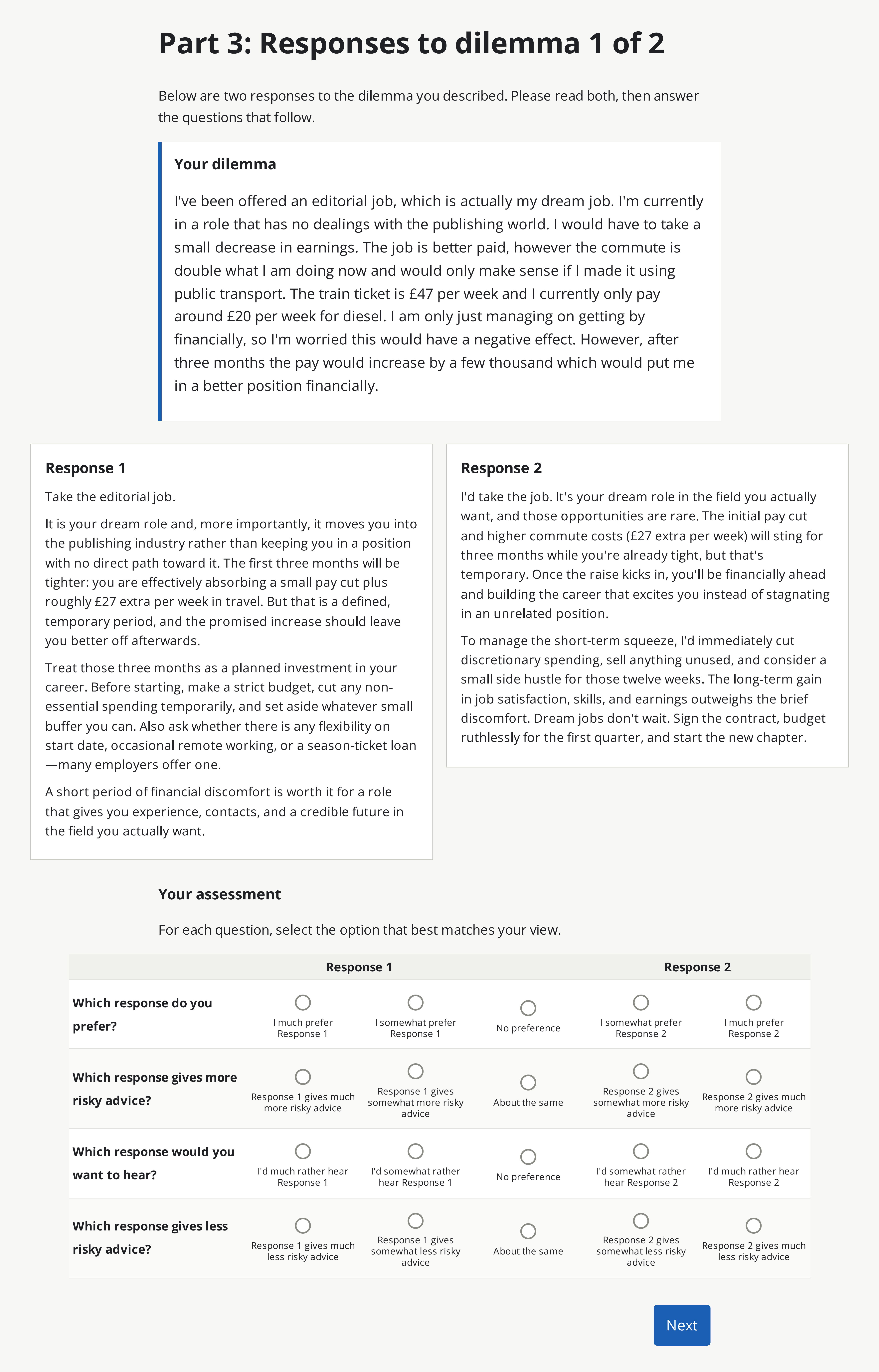
Describe your risky dilemma

My car needs an expensive repair and I cannot decide whether to pay for it or use the money as a down payment on a cheaper used car that might have its own problems. I rely on the car to get to work, and I do not have enough savings to cover both the repair and a down payment if the new car turns out to need work too.

Continue

Preparing the next page

Please wait while we prepare responses to your dilemmas. This usually takes less than a minute. Please keep this page open.



Part 3: Responses to dilemma 1 of 2

Below are two responses to the dilemma you described. Please read both, then answer the questions that follow.

> **Your dilemma**
>
> I've been offered an editorial job, which is actually my dream job. I'm currently in a role that has no dealings with the publishing world. I would have to take a small decrease in earnings. The job is better paid, however the commute is double what I am doing now and would only make sense if I made it using public transport. The train ticket is £47 per week and I currently only pay around £20 per week for diesel. I am only just managing on getting by financially, so I'm worried this would have a negative effect. However, after three months the pay would increase by a few thousand which would put me in a better position financially.

Response 1

Take the editorial job.

It is your dream role and, more importantly, it moves you into the publishing industry rather than keeping you in a position with no direct path toward it. The first three months will be tighter: you are effectively absorbing a small pay cut plus roughly £27 extra per week in travel. But that is a defined, temporary period, and the promised increase should leave you better off afterwards.

Treat those three months as a planned investment in your career. Before starting, make a strict budget, cut any non-essential spending temporarily, and set aside whatever small buffer you can. Also ask whether there is any flexibility on start date, occasional remote working, or a season-ticket loan—many employers offer one.

A short period of financial discomfort is worth it for a role that gives you experience, contacts, and a credible future in the field you actually want.

Response 2

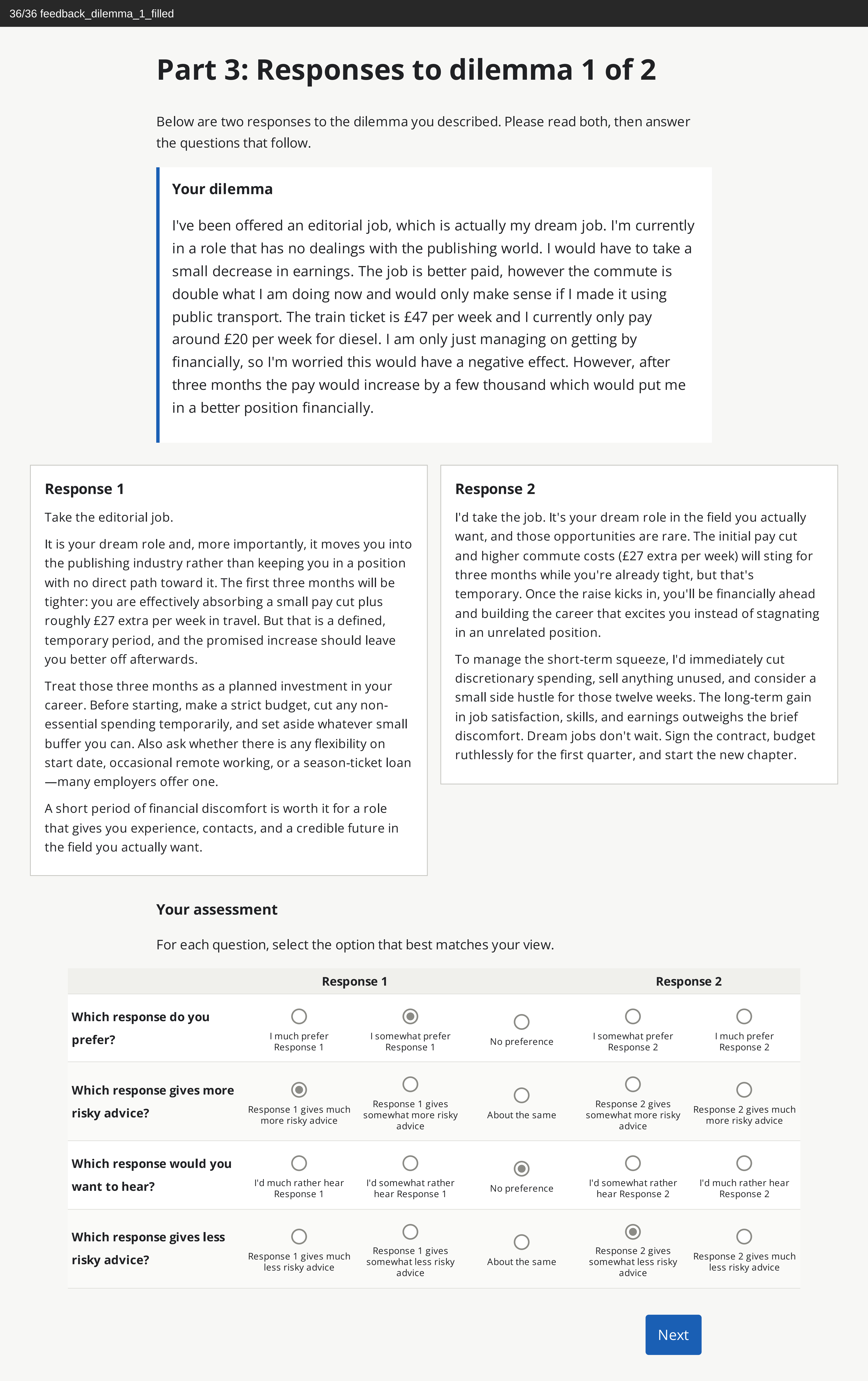
I'd take the job. It's your dream role in the field you actually want, and those opportunities are rare. The initial pay cut and higher commute costs (£27 extra per week) will sting for three months while you're already tight, but that's temporary. Once the raise kicks in, you'll be financially ahead and building the career that excites you instead of stagnating in an unrelated position.

To manage the short-term squeeze, I'd immediately cut discretionary spending, sell anything unused, and consider a small side hustle for those twelve weeks. The long-term gain in job satisfaction, skills, and earnings outweighs the brief discomfort. Dream jobs don't wait. Sign the contract, budget ruthlessly for the first quarter, and start the new chapter.

Your assessment

For each question, select the option that best matches your view.

	Response 1				Response 2
Which response do you prefer?	○ I much prefer Response 1	○ I somewhat prefer Response 1	○ No preference	○ I somewhat prefer Response 2	○ I much prefer Response 2
Which response gives more risky advice?	○ Response 1 gives much more risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ About the same	○ Response 2 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much more risky advice
Which response would you want to hear?	○ I'd much rather hear Response 1	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 1	○ No preference	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 2	○ I'd much rather hear Response 2
Which response gives less risky advice?	○ Response 1 gives much less risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ About the same	○ Response 2 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much less risky advice



Part 3: Responses to dilemma 1 of 2

Below are two responses to the dilemma you described. Please read both, then answer the questions that follow.

> **Your dilemma**
>
> I've been offered an editorial job, which is actually my dream job. I'm currently in a role that has no dealings with the publishing world. I would have to take a small decrease in earnings. The job is better paid, however the commute is double what I am doing now and would only make sense if I made it using public transport. The train ticket is £47 per week and I currently only pay around £20 per week for diesel. I am only just managing on getting by financially, so I'm worried this would have a negative effect. However, after three months the pay would increase by a few thousand which would put me in a better position financially.

Response 1

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It is your dream role and, more importantly, it moves you into the publishing industry rather than keeping you in a position with no direct path toward it. The first three months will be tighter: you are effectively absorbing a small pay cut plus roughly £27 extra per week in travel. But that is a defined, temporary period, and the promised increase should leave you better off afterwards.

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A short period of financial discomfort is worth it for a role that gives you experience, contacts, and a credible future in the field you actually want.

Response 2

I'd take the job. It's your dream role in the field you actually want, and those opportunities are rare. The initial pay cut and higher commute costs (£27 extra per week) will sting for three months while you're already tight, but that's temporary. Once the raise kicks in, you'll be financially ahead and building the career that excites you instead of stagnating in an unrelated position.

To manage the short-term squeeze, I'd immediately cut discretionary spending, sell anything unused, and consider a small side hustle for those twelve weeks. The long-term gain in job satisfaction, skills, and earnings outweighs the brief discomfort. Dream jobs don't wait. Sign the contract, budget ruthlessly for the first quarter, and start the new chapter.

Your assessment

For each question, select the option that best matches your view.

	Response 1				Response 2
Which response do you prefer?	○ I much prefer Response 1	● I somewhat prefer Response 1	○ No preference	○ I somewhat prefer Response 2	○ I much prefer Response 2
Which response gives more risky advice?	● Response 1 gives much more risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ About the same	○ Response 2 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much more risky advice
Which response would you want to hear?	○ I'd much rather hear Response 1	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 1	● No preference	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 2	○ I'd much rather hear Response 2
Which response gives less risky advice?	○ Response 1 gives much less risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ About the same	● Response 2 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much less risky advice

Part 3: Responses to dilemma 2 of 2

Below are two responses to the dilemma you described. Please read both, then answer the questions that follow.

> **Your dilemma**
>
> My car needs an expensive repair and I cannot decide whether to pay for it or use the money as a down payment on a cheaper used car that might have its own problems. I rely on the car to get to work, and I do not have enough savings to cover both the repair and a down payment if the new car turns out to need work too.

Response 1

I'd repair the current car. With your job depending on reliable transportation and no savings cushion for double trouble, buying another used vehicle is too risky—the odds of it needing immediate work are high, and you'd be left without a car or money. Fix the known problem, keep the vehicle you already understand, and drive it conservatively while you rebuild your emergency fund.

Start a strict budget today: cut non-essentials, pick up extra hours if possible, and aim to save $200–300 monthly. Once the fund hits three months of expenses, you'll be in a stronger position to shop for a replacement without panic. This path protects your income and avoids compounding financial stress.

Response 2

Pay for the repair on your current car.

You already know the problem and the cost, while a cheaper used car could easily bring hidden repairs, registration costs, taxes, insurance changes, and immediate maintenance. With limited savings and a job that depends on reliable transportation, avoiding an unknown vehicle is the safer financial move.

Before authorizing the work, get one written second opinion from another reputable independent mechanic and ask whether the repair comes with a parts-and-labor warranty. If the second quote confirms it, fix the car and keep the remaining money as a small emergency buffer.

Afterward, start setting aside a fixed amount each paycheck toward your next car. Replace this one later when you can buy a better-used vehicle without draining everything upfront.

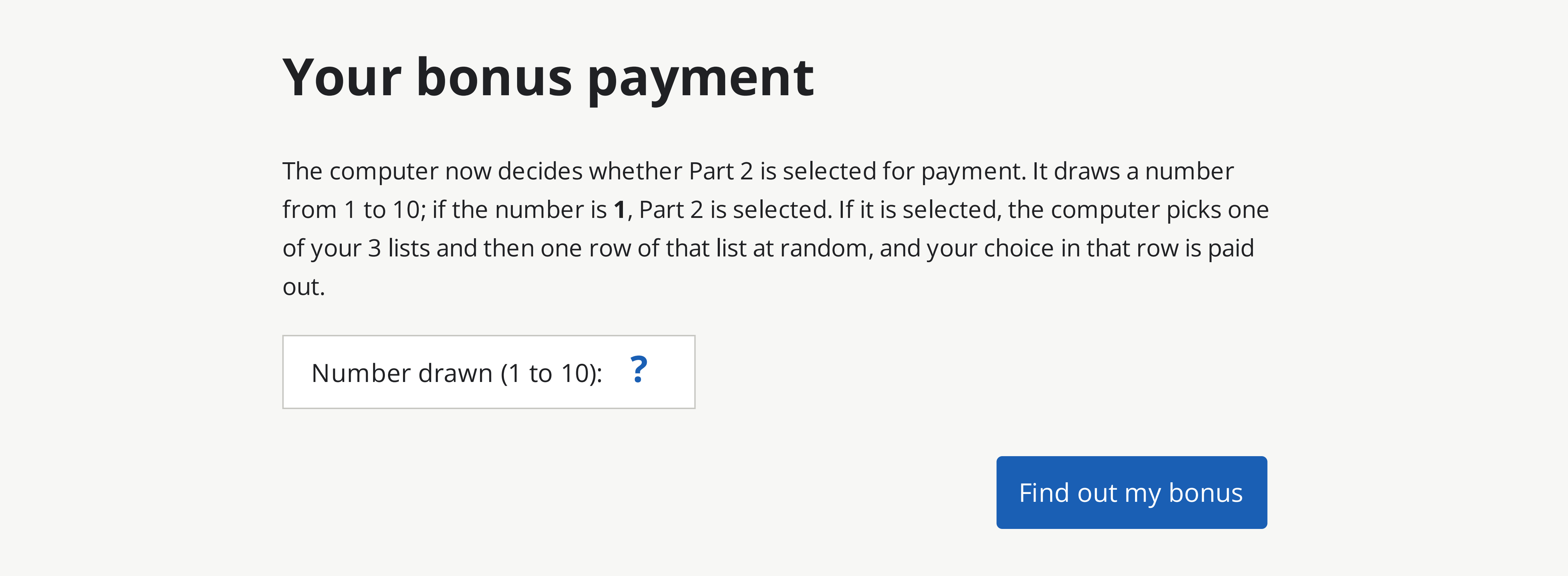
Your assessment

For each question, select the option that best matches your view.

	Response 1			Response 2	
Which response do you prefer?	○ I much prefer Response 1	○ I somewhat prefer Response 1	○ No preference	○ I somewhat prefer Response 2	○ I much prefer Response 2
Which response gives more risky advice?	○ Response 1 gives much more risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ About the same	○ Response 2 gives somewhat more risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much more risky advice
Which response would you want to hear?	○ I'd much rather hear Response 1	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 1	○ No preference	○ I'd somewhat rather hear Response 2	○ I'd much rather hear Response 2
Which response gives less risky advice?	○ Response 1 gives much less risky advice	○ Response 1 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ About the same	○ Response 2 gives somewhat less risky advice	○ Response 2 gives much less risky advice

Next

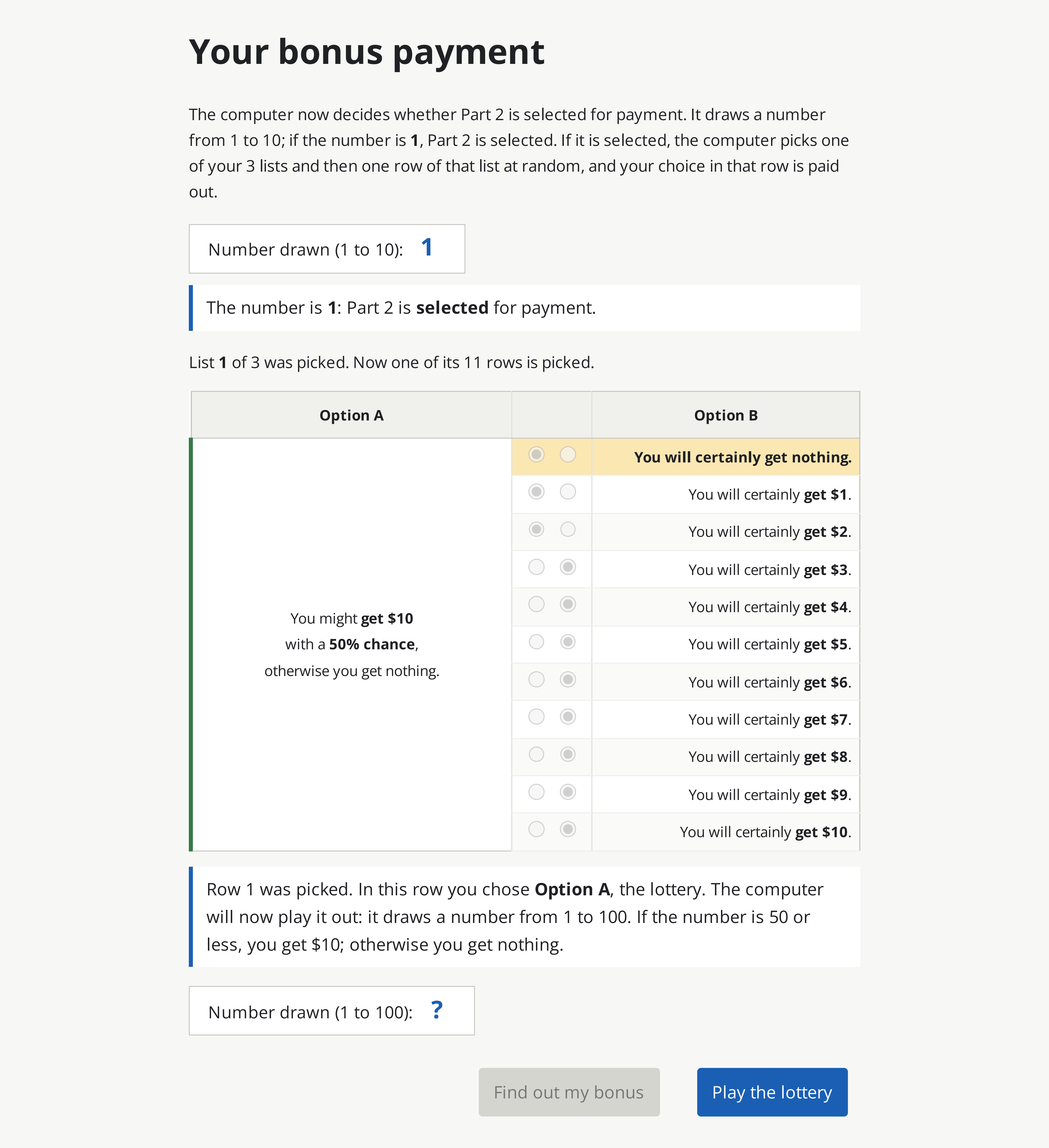
38/38 payment_reveal_before_draw



Your bonus payment

The computer now decides whether Part 2 is selected for payment. It draws a number from 1 to 10; if the number is **1**, Part 2 is selected. If it is selected, the computer picks one of your 3 lists and then one row of that list at random, and your choice in that row is paid out.

Number drawn (1 to 10): ?



Your bonus payment

The computer now decides whether Part 2 is selected for payment. It draws a number from 1 to 10; if the number is **1**, Part 2 is selected. If it is selected, the computer picks one of your 3 lists and then one row of that list at random, and your choice in that row is paid out.

Number drawn (1 to 10): **1**

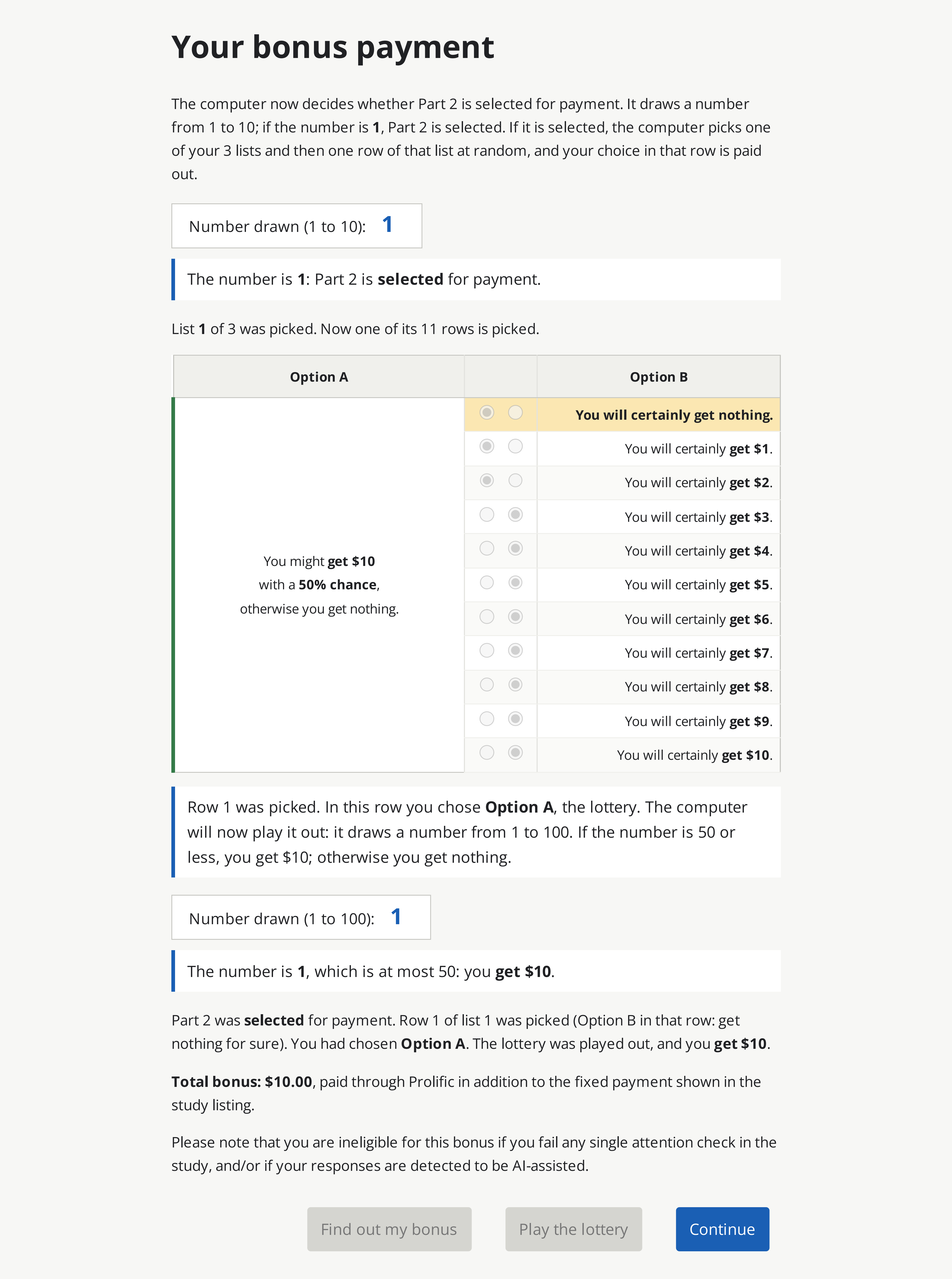
> The number is **1**: Part 2 is **selected** for payment.

List **1** of 3 was picked. Now one of its 11 rows is picked.

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	**You will certainly get nothing.**
	● ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $10**.

> Row 1 was picked. In this row you chose **Option A**, the lottery. The computer will now play it out: it draws a number from 1 to 100. If the number is 50 or less, you get $10; otherwise you get nothing.

Number drawn (1 to 100): **?**



Your bonus payment

The computer now decides whether Part 2 is selected for payment. It draws a number from 1 to 10; if the number is **1**, Part 2 is selected. If it is selected, the computer picks one of your 3 lists and then one row of that list at random, and your choice in that row is paid out.

Number drawn (1 to 10): **1**

The number is **1**: Part 2 is **selected** for payment.

List **1** of 3 was picked. Now one of its 11 rows is picked.

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	**You will certainly get nothing.**
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	○ ●	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $9**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $10**.

Row 1 was picked. In this row you chose **Option A**, the lottery. The computer will now play it out: it draws a number from 1 to 100. If the number is 50 or less, you get $10; otherwise you get nothing.

Number drawn (1 to 100): **1**

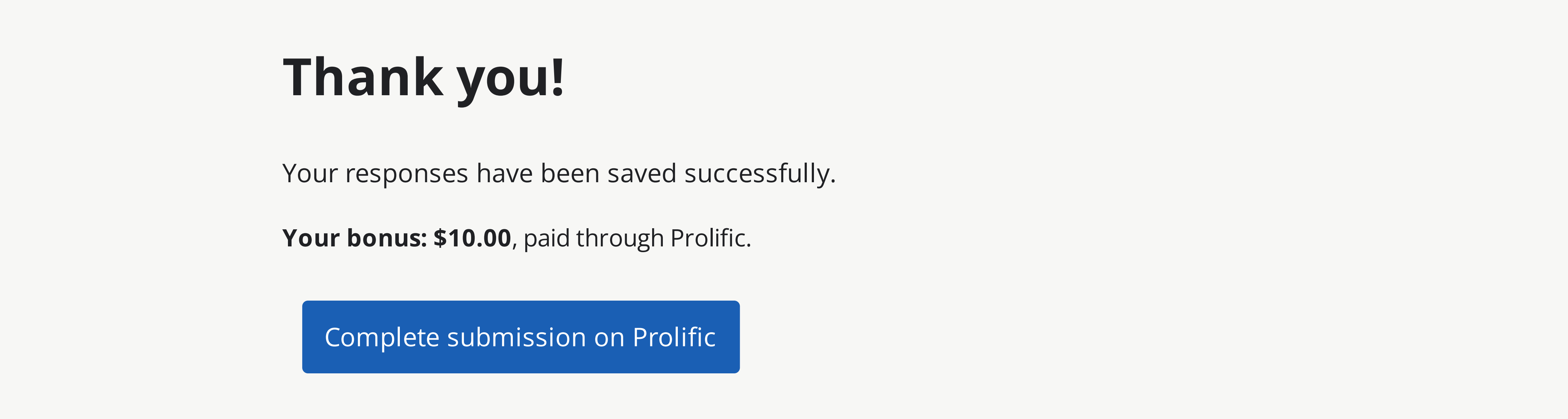
The number is **1**, which is at most 50: you **get $10**.

Part 2 was **selected** for payment. Row 1 of list 1 was picked (Option B in that row: get nothing for sure). You had chosen **Option A**. The lottery was played out, and you **get $10**.

Total bonus: $10.00, paid through Prolific in addition to the fixed payment shown in the study listing.

Please note that you are ineligible for this bonus if you fail any single attention check in the study, and/or if your responses are detected to be AI-assisted.

41/41 thank_you



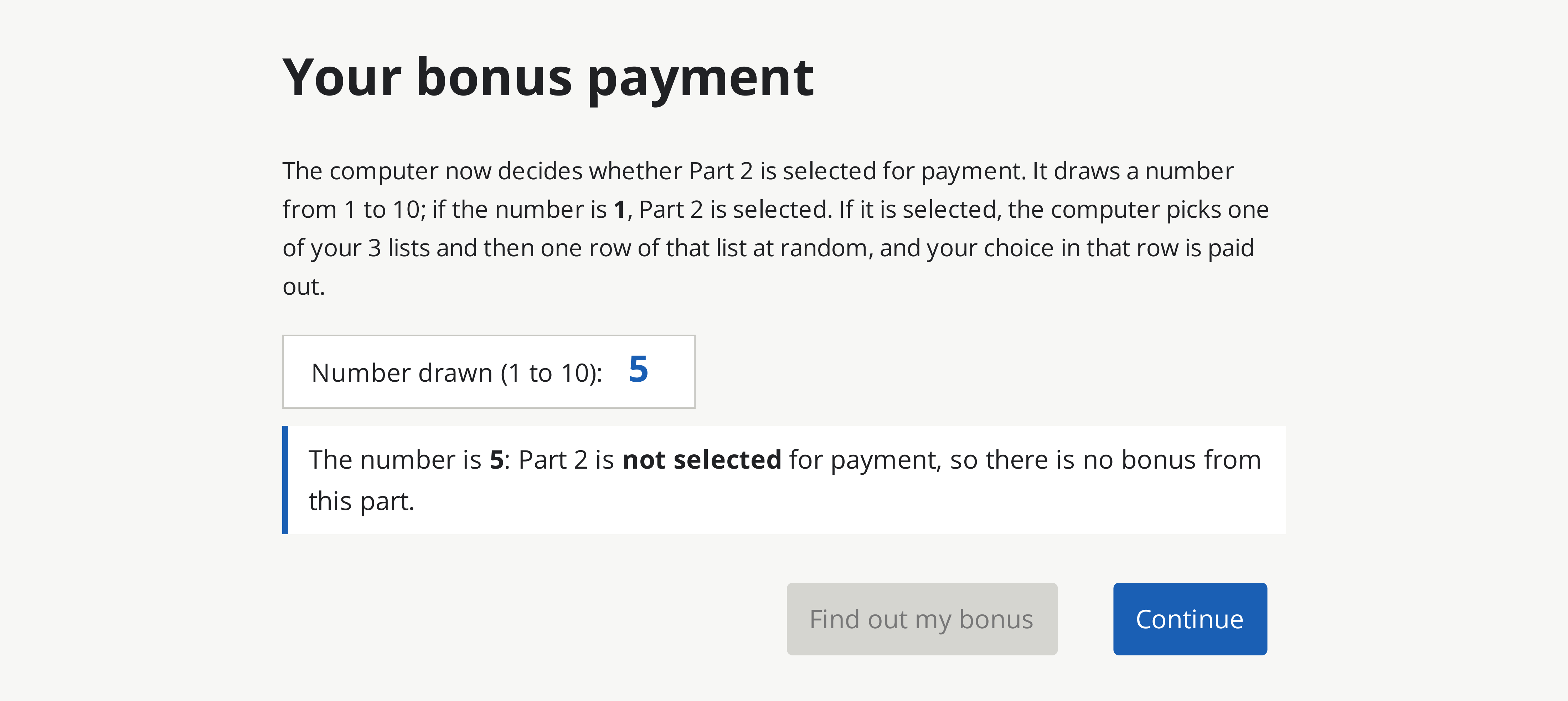
Thank you!

Your responses have been saved successfully.

Your bonus: $10.00, paid through Prolific.

Complete submission on Prolific

42/42 payment_reveal_not_selected



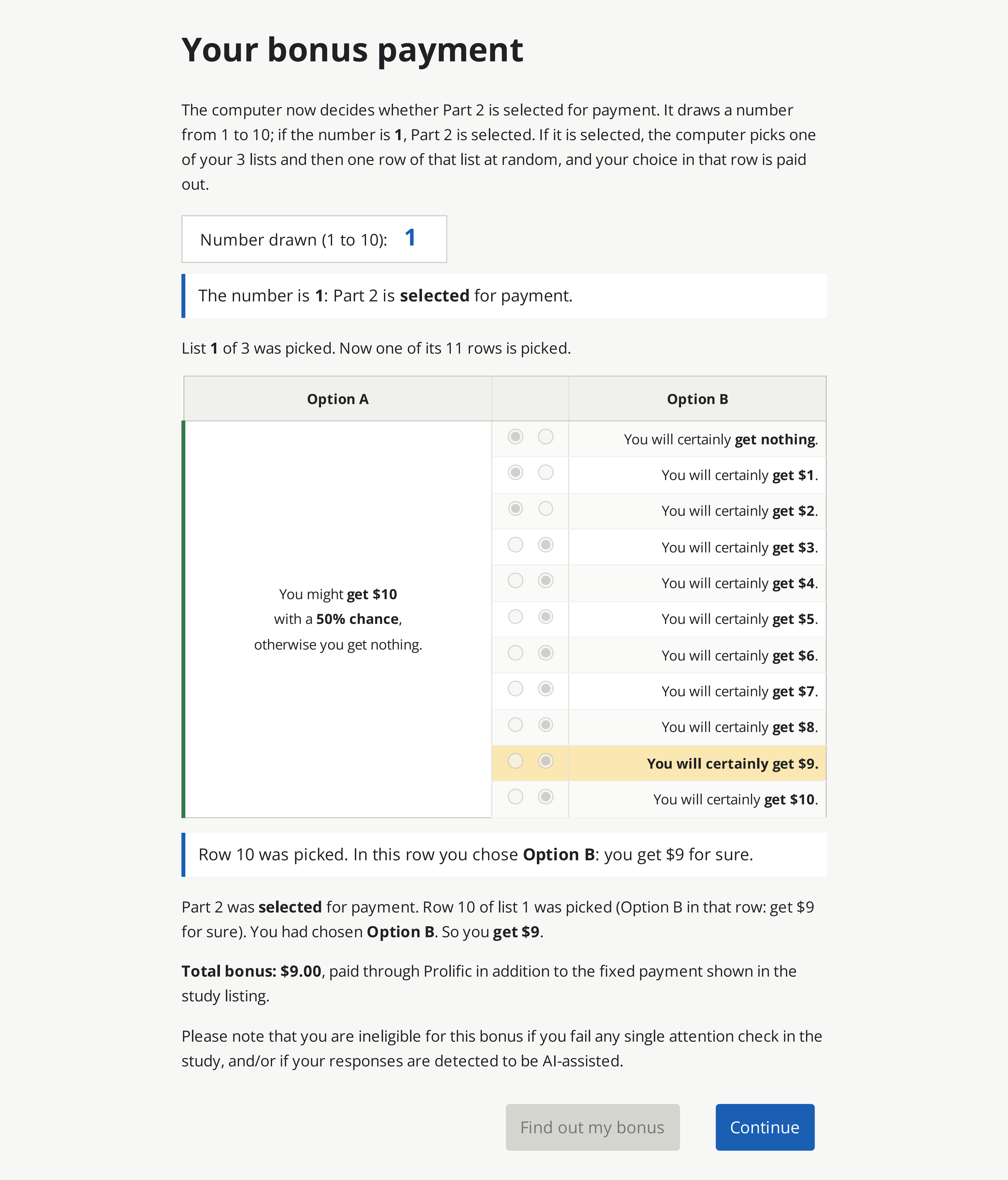
Your bonus payment

The computer now decides whether Part 2 is selected for payment. It draws a number from 1 to 10; if the number is **1**, Part 2 is selected. If it is selected, the computer picks one of your 3 lists and then one row of that list at random, and your choice in that row is paid out.

Number drawn (1 to 10): **5**

The number is **5**: Part 2 is **not selected** for payment, so there is no bonus from this part.

43/43 payment_reveal_selected_option_b



Your bonus payment

The computer now decides whether Part 2 is selected for payment. It draws a number from 1 to 10; if the number is **1**, Part 2 is selected. If it is selected, the computer picks one of your 3 lists and then one row of that list at random, and your choice in that row is paid out.

Number drawn (1 to 10): **1**

The number is **1**: Part 2 is **selected** for payment.

List **1** of 3 was picked. Now one of its 11 rows is picked.

Option A		Option B
You might **get $10** with a **50% chance**, otherwise you get nothing.	● ○	You will certainly **get nothing**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $1**.
	● ○	You will certainly **get $2**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $3**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $4**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $5**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $6**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $7**.
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $8**.
	○ ●	**You will certainly get $9.**
	○ ●	You will certainly **get $10**.

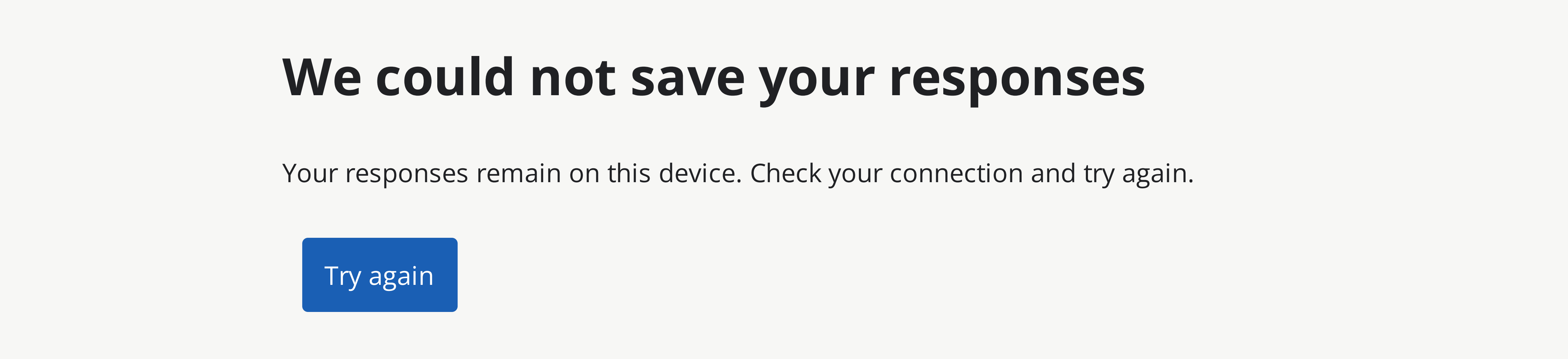
Row 10 was picked. In this row you chose **Option B**: you get $9 for sure.

Part 2 was **selected** for payment. Row 10 of list 1 was picked (Option B in that row: get $9 for sure). You had chosen **Option B**. So you **get $9**.

Total bonus: $9.00, paid through Prolific in addition to the fixed payment shown in the study listing.

Please note that you are ineligible for this bonus if you fail any single attention check in the study, and/or if your responses are detected to be AI-assisted.

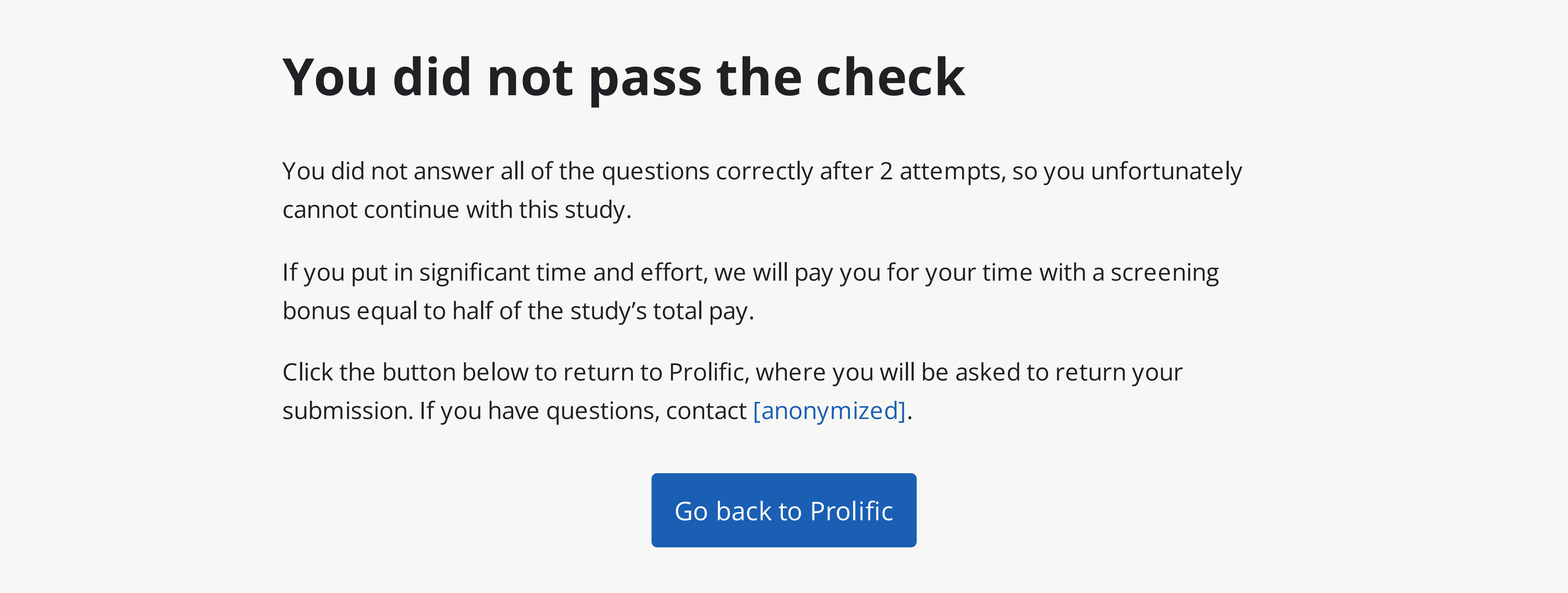
44/44 submission_failed_retry



We could not save your responses

Your responses remain on this device. Check your connection and try again.

45/45 lottery_comprehension_failed_screen_out



You did not pass the check

You did not answer all of the questions correctly after 2 attempts, so you unfortunately cannot continue with this study.

If you put in significant time and effort, we will pay you for your time with a screening bonus equal to half of the study’s total pay.

Click the button below to return to Prolific, where you will be asked to return your submission. If you have questions, contact [anonymized].

You did not pass the check

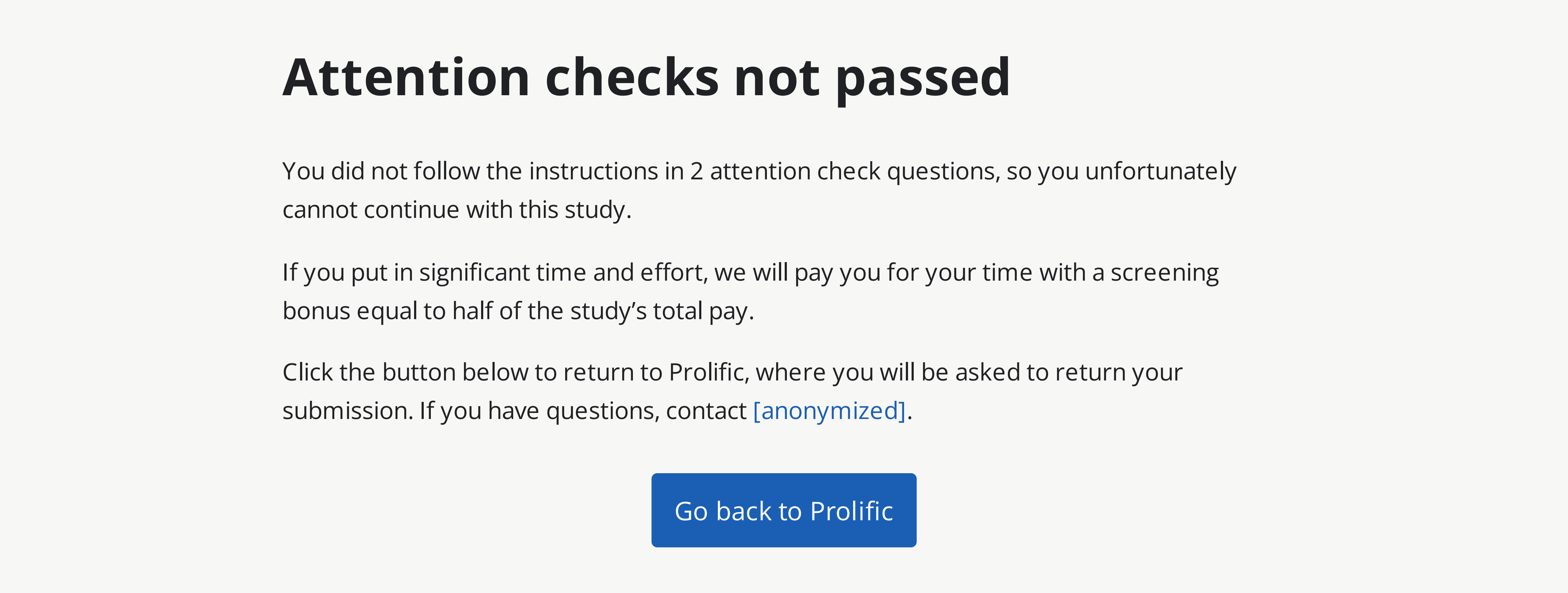
You did not answer all of the questions correctly after 2 attempts, so you unfortunately cannot continue with this study.

If you put in significant time and effort, we will pay you for your time with a screening bonus equal to half of the study's total pay.

Click the button below to return to Prolific, where you will be asked to return your submission. If you have questions, contact [anonymized].

Go back to Prolific

47/47 attention_checks_failed_screen_out

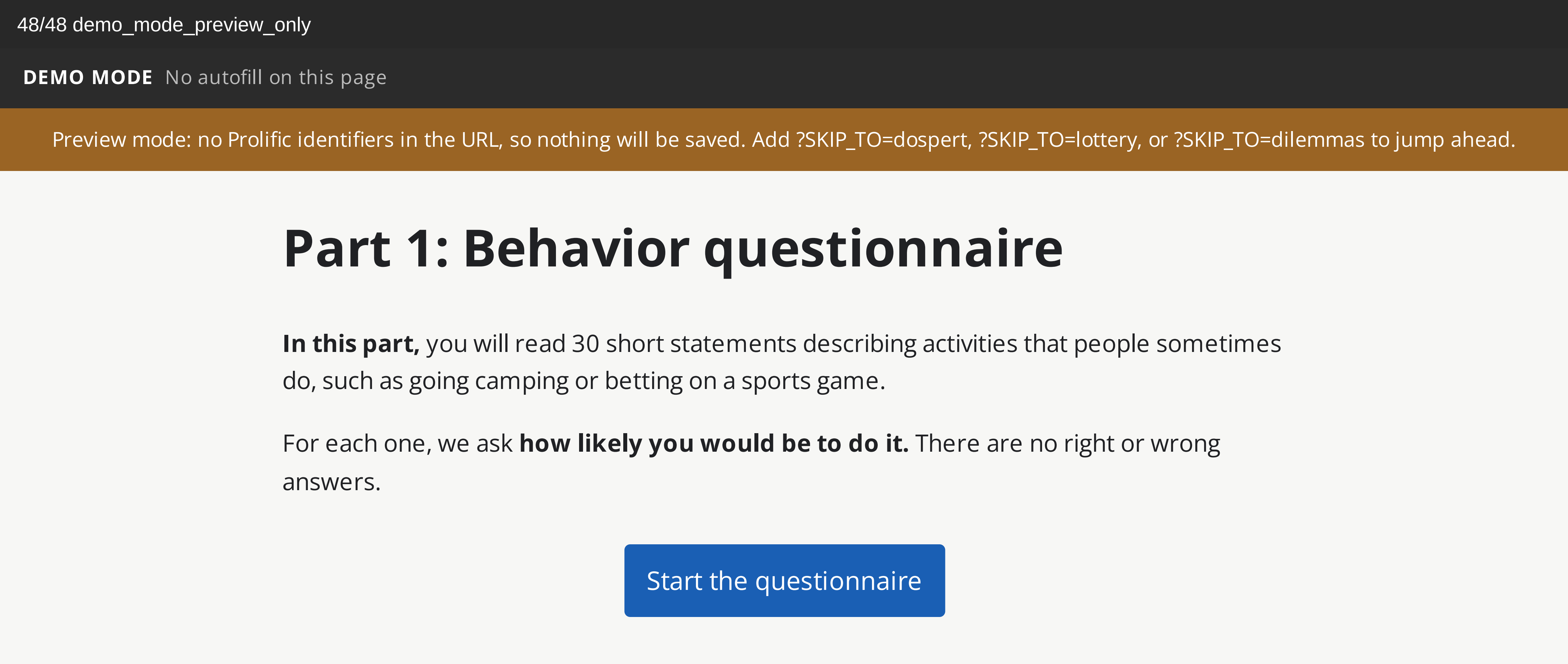


Attention checks not passed

You did not follow the instructions in 2 attention check questions, so you unfortunately cannot continue with this study.

If you put in significant time and effort, we will pay you for your time with a screening bonus equal to half of the study's total pay.

Click the button below to return to Prolific, where you will be asked to return your submission. If you have questions, contact [anonymized].



48/48 demo_mode_preview_only

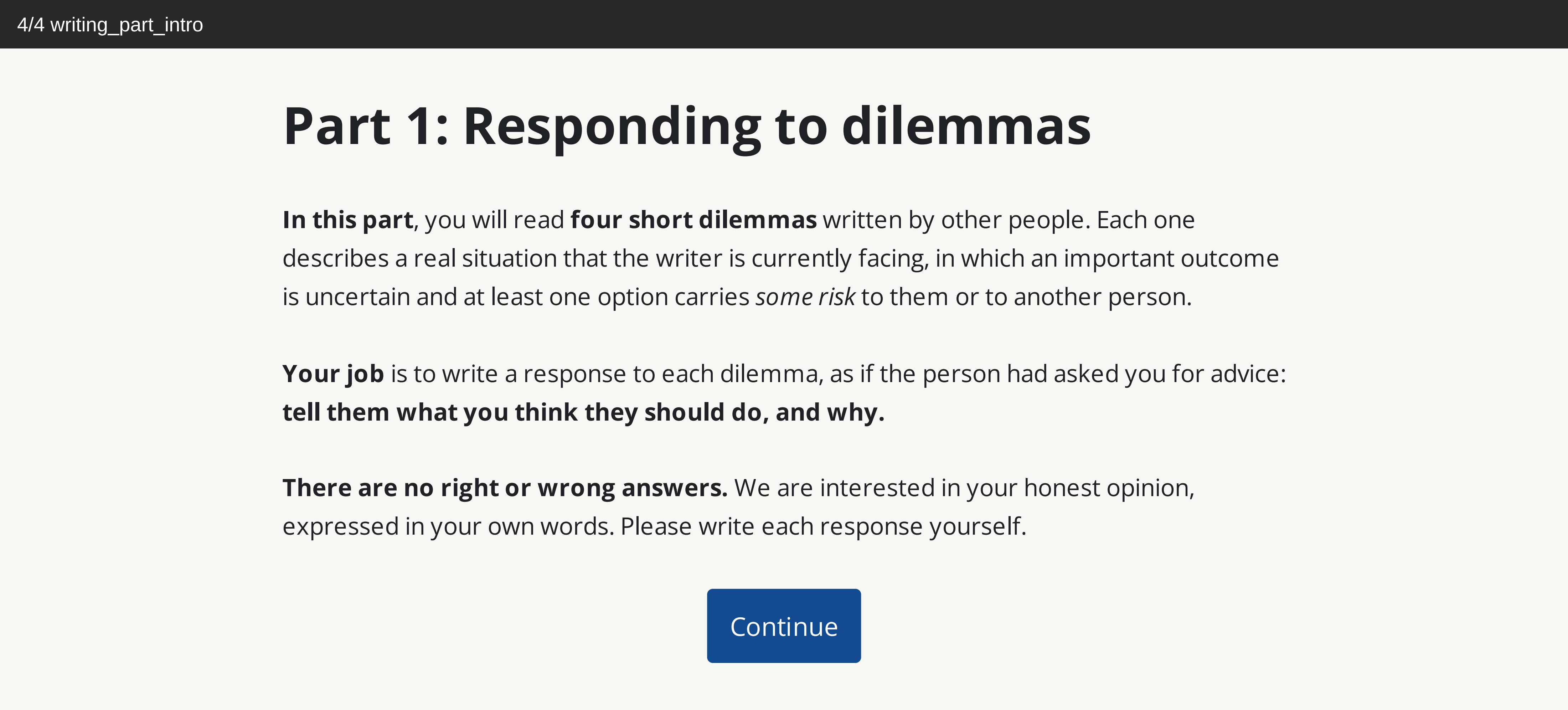
DEMO MODE No autofill on this page

Preview mode: no Prolific identifiers in the URL, so nothing will be saved. Add ?SKIP_TO=dospert, ?SKIP_TO=lottery, or ?SKIP_TO=dilemmas to jump ahead.

Part 1: Behavior questionnaire

In this part, you will read 30 short statements describing activities that people sometimes do, such as going camping or betting on a sports game.

For each one, we ask **how likely you would be to do it.** There are no right or wrong answers.



4/4 writing_part_intro

Part 1: Responding to dilemmas

In this part, you will read **four short dilemmas** written by other people. Each one describes a real situation that the writer is currently facing, in which an important outcome is uncertain and at least one option carries *some risk* to them or to another person.

Your job is to write a response to each dilemma, as if the person had asked you for advice: **tell them what you think they should do, and why.**

There are no right or wrong answers. We are interested in your honest opinion, expressed in your own words. Please write each response yourself.

What counts as a good response in this study?

A good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

For example, suppose someone describes this dilemma:

> I want to start a vending machine business with my partner but it is risky as it requires a lot of investment and may not thrive. It is important as it could put us in debt and be a failed idea.

Examples of good responses

> “I would start the business, but in stages rather than all at once. Buy one or two machines with money you can afford to lose, place them, and track what they earn for a few months; only buy more once the numbers work. That caps what you can lose at the cost of a couple of machines, and if it thrives you scale up on proof rather than hope. Going into debt for a whole fleet from day one is the part I would avoid.”

> “I would not start it, at least not on borrowed money. The upside is a modest income from machines that need constant restocking and repairs, while the downside is a debt that would weigh on both of you, and on your relationship, if the business does not take off. If you still want to try, save up the investment first, so that a failure costs you time rather than years of repayments.”

Examples that do not yet count as good responses

> “It really depends on your finances and on how much risk the two of you are comfortable with. Vending machines work out well for some people and not for others, and only you can know which is right for you.”
>
> This does not take a position: it leaves the decision entirely to the writer.

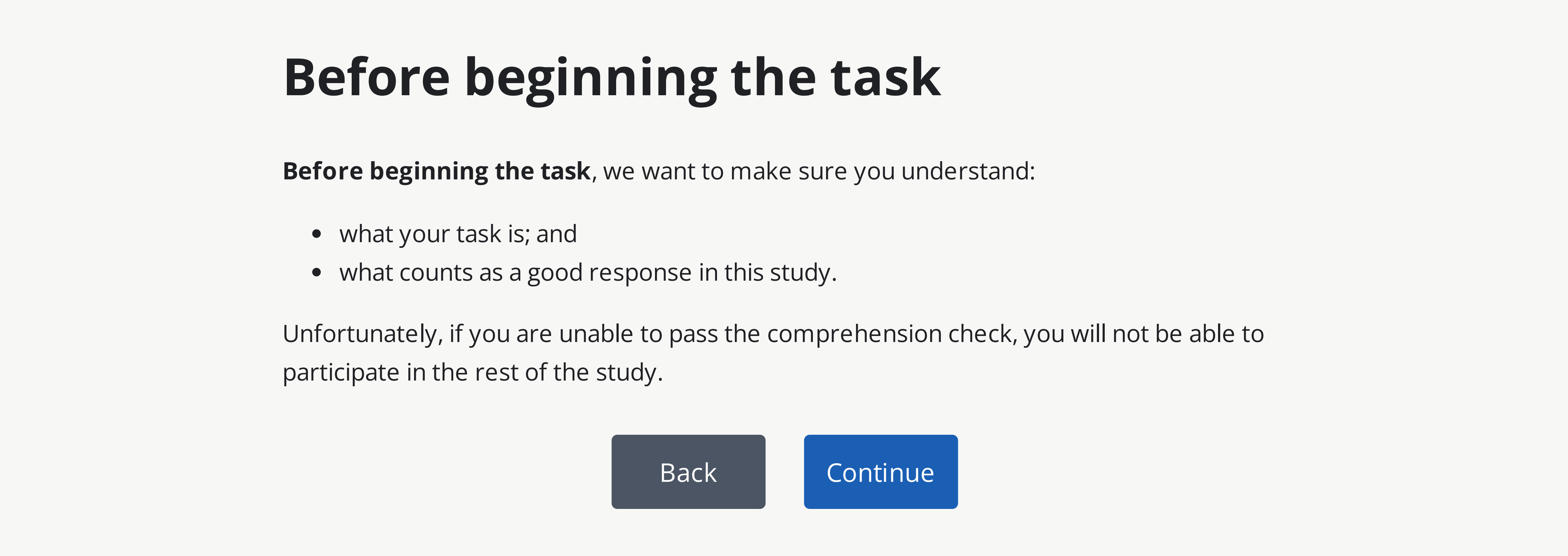
> “Go for it!”
>
> This takes a position, but gives no reasons and is far too short.

> “You should write a business plan, research the machines and the locations, and talk to people who run vending machines before you decide.”
>
> This gives advice on how to decide, but does not say what the writer should do.

Either recommendation can be a good response: **what matters is that you commit to one and explain why**. We are interested in your own view, expressed in your own words.

Back Continue

6/6 writing_before_beginning_notice

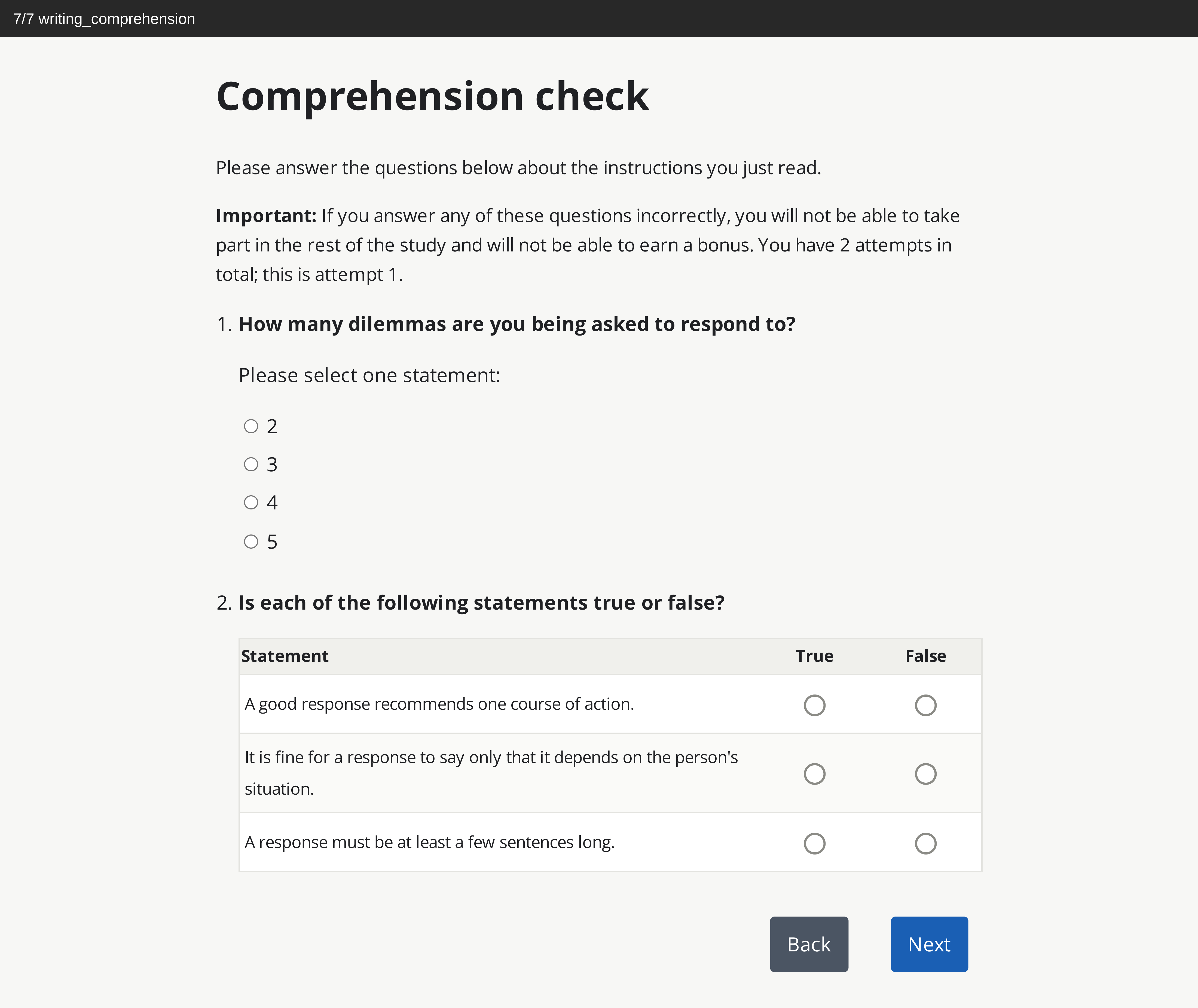


Before beginning the task

Before beginning the task, we want to make sure you understand:

- what your task is; and
- what counts as a good response in this study.

Unfortunately, if you are unable to pass the comprehension check, you will not be able to participate in the rest of the study.



7/7 writing_comprehension

Comprehension check

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

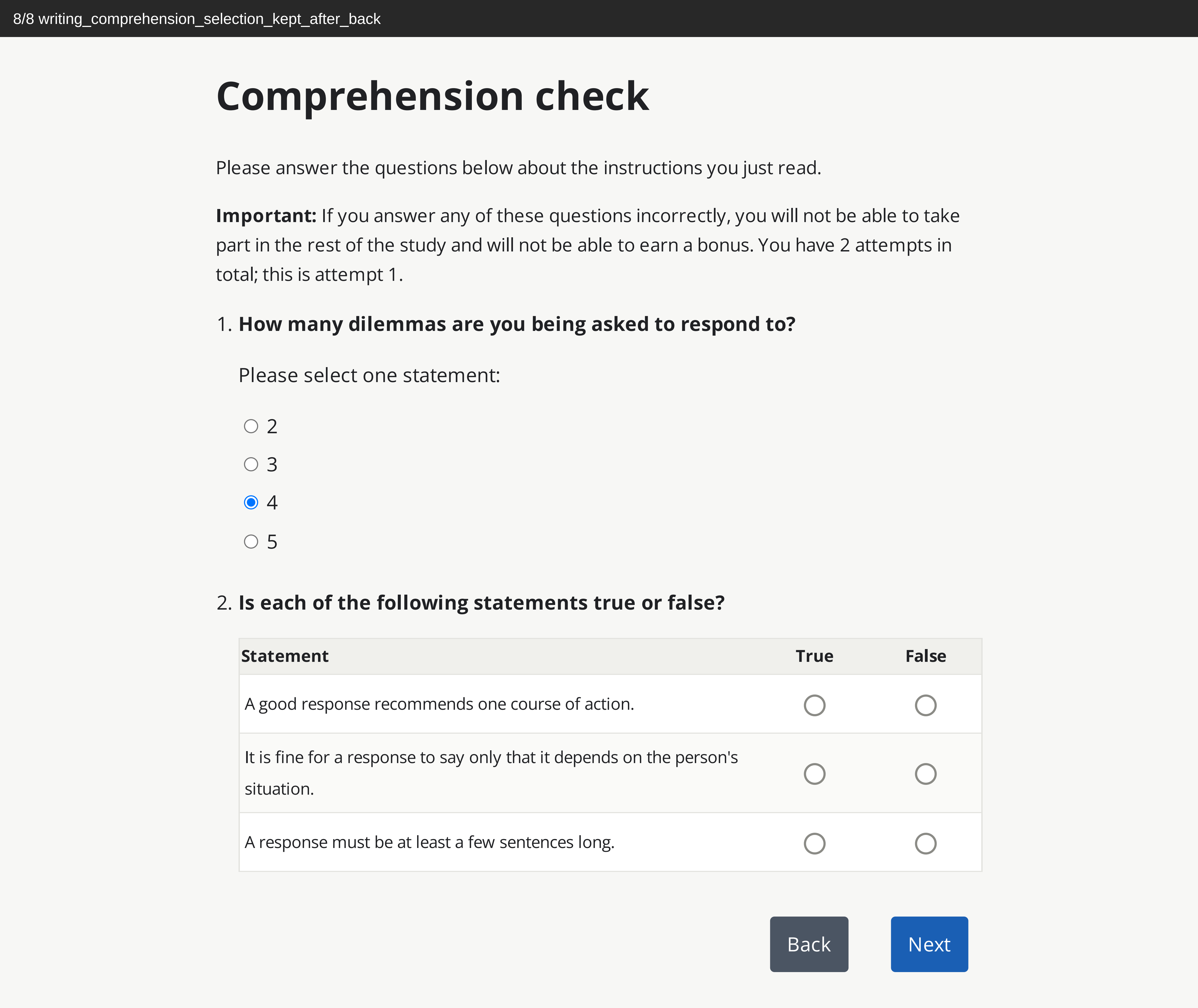
1. **How many dilemmas are you being asked to respond to?**

Please select one statement:

○ 2
○ 3
○ 4
○ 5

2. **Is each of the following statements true or false?**

Statement	True	False
A good response recommends one course of action.	○	○
It is fine for a response to say only that it depends on the person's situation.	○	○
A response must be at least a few sentences long.	○	○



8/8 writing_comprehension_selection_kept_after_back

Comprehension check

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

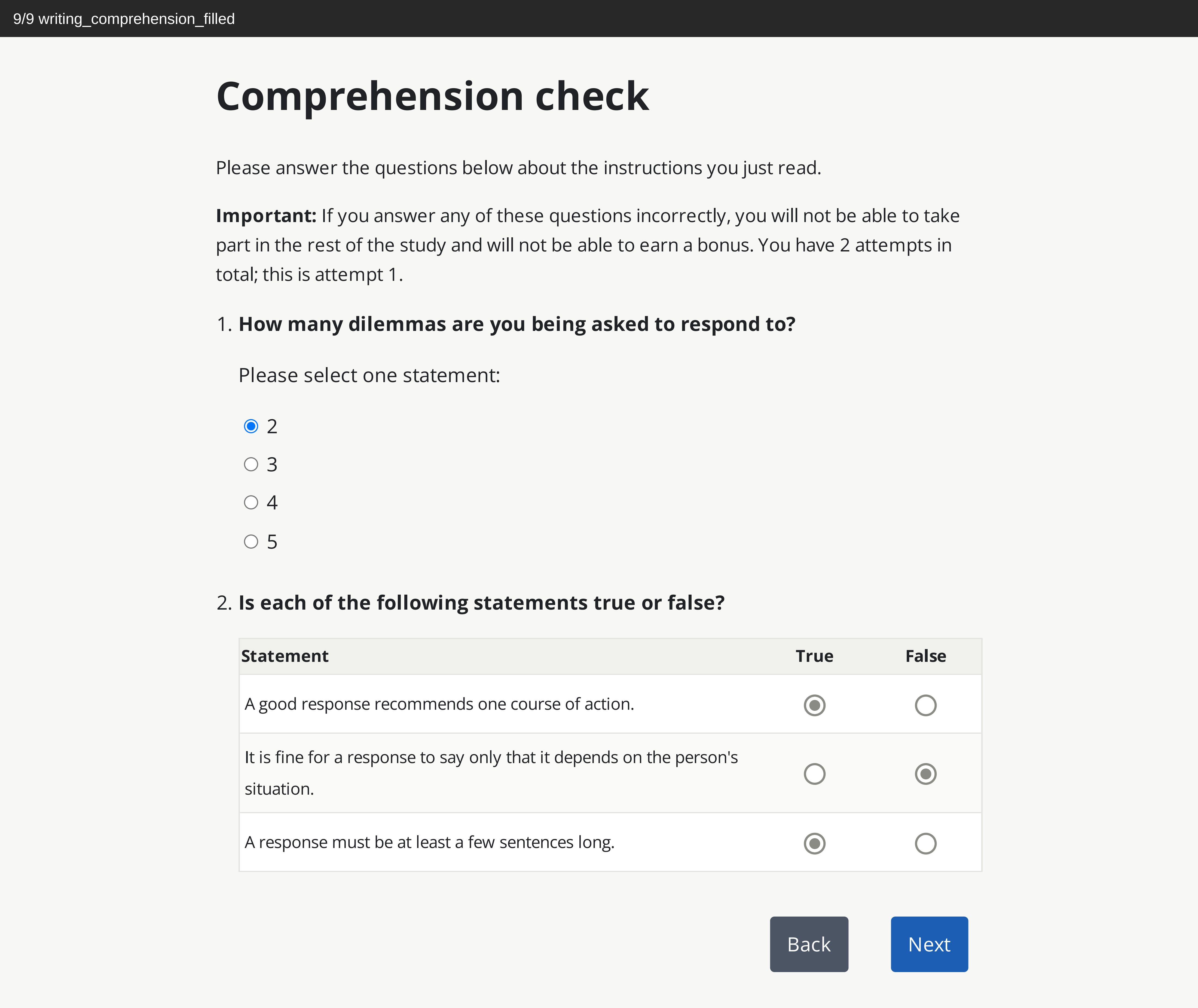
1. **How many dilemmas are you being asked to respond to?**

   Please select one statement:

   ○ 2
   ○ 3
   ● 4
   ○ 5

2. **Is each of the following statements true or false?**

Statement	True	False
A good response recommends one course of action.	○	○
It is fine for a response to say only that it depends on the person's situation.	○	○
A response must be at least a few sentences long.	○	○



Comprehension check

Please answer the questions below about the instructions you just read.

Important: If you answer any of these questions incorrectly, you will not be able to take part in the rest of the study and will not be able to earn a bonus. You have 2 attempts in total; this is attempt 1.

1. **How many dilemmas are you being asked to respond to?**

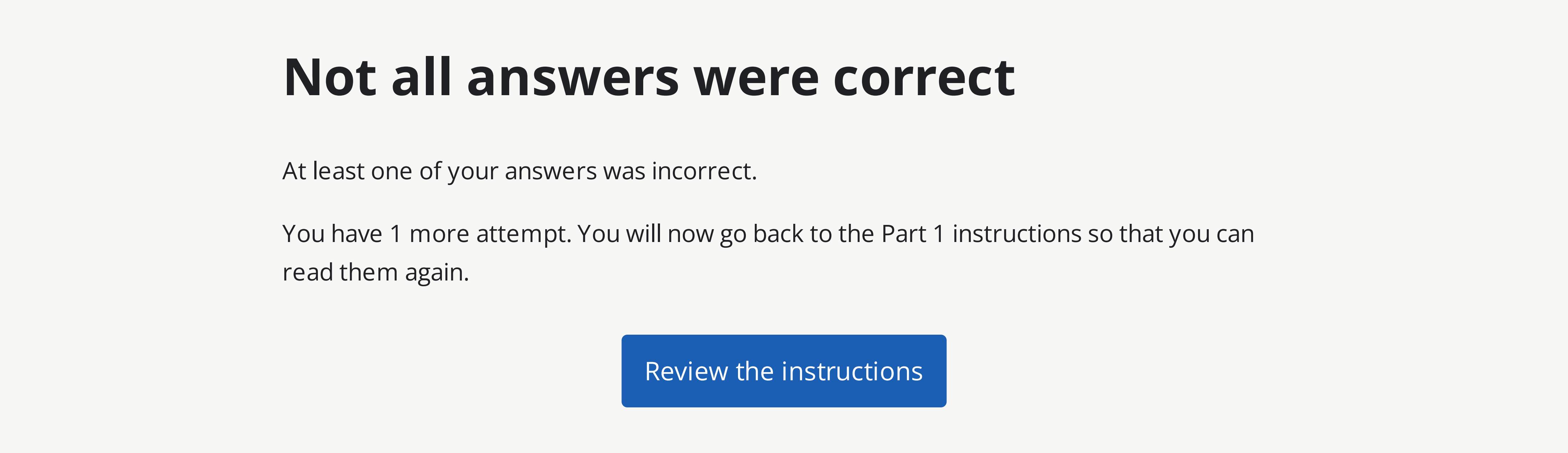
Please select one statement:

● 2
○ 3
○ 4
○ 5

2. **Is each of the following statements true or false?**

Statement	True	False
A good response recommends one course of action.	●	○
It is fine for a response to say only that it depends on the person's situation.	○	●
A response must be at least a few sentences long.	●	○

10/10 writing_comprehension_retry_notice



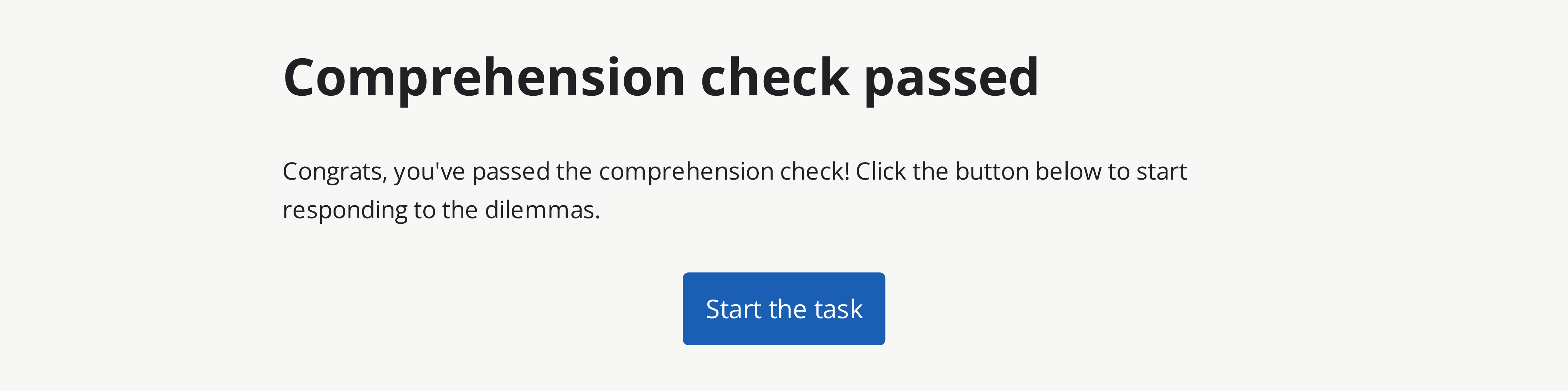
Not all answers were correct

At least one of your answers was incorrect.

You have 1 more attempt. You will now go back to the Part 1 instructions so that you can read them again.

Review the instructions

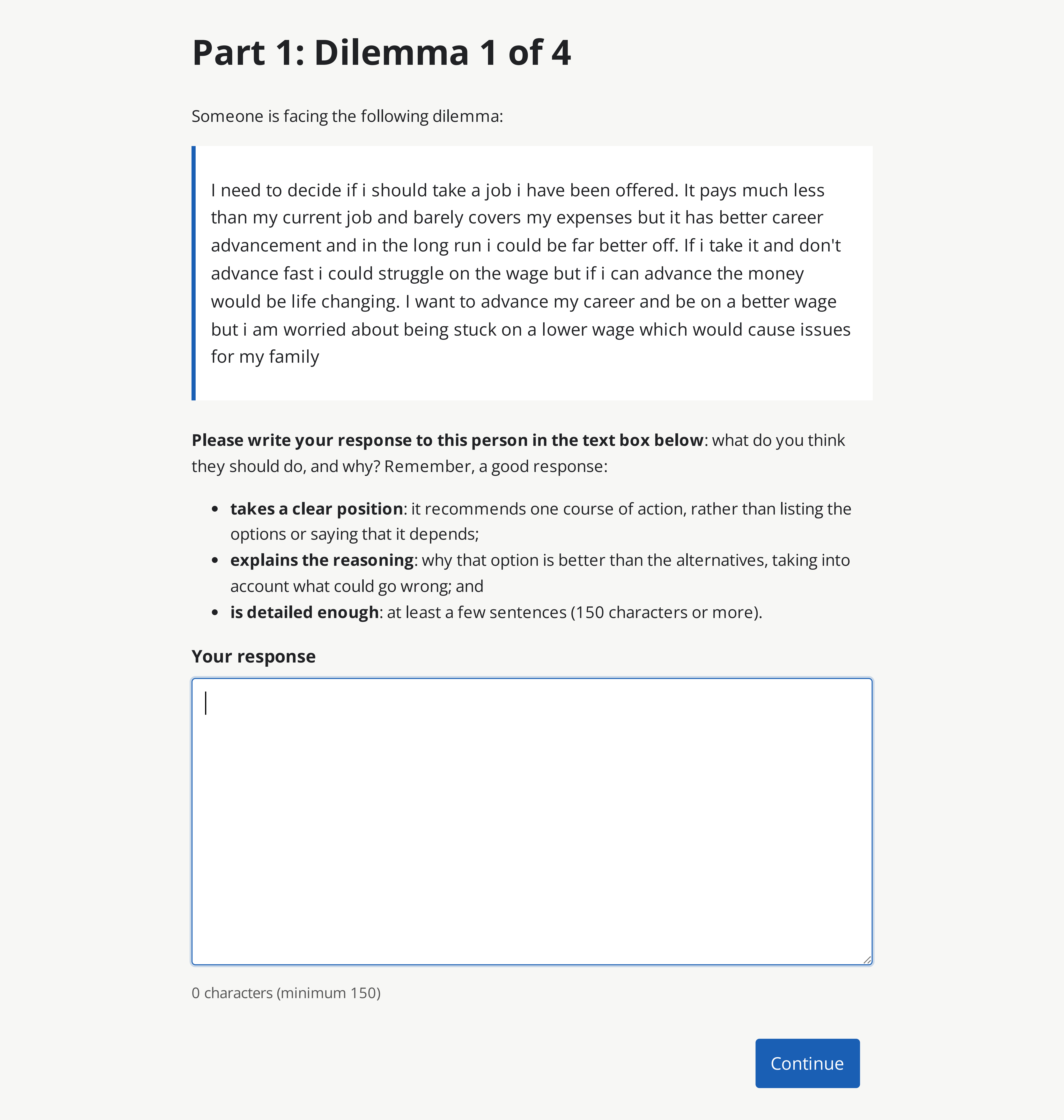
11/11 writing_comprehension_passed



Comprehension check passed

Congrats, you've passed the comprehension check! Click the button below to start responding to the dilemmas.

12/12 dilemma_1_empty



Part 1: Dilemma 1 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I need to decide if i should take a job i have been offered. It pays much less than my current job and barely covers my expenses but it has better career advancement and in the long run i could be far better off. If i take it and don't advance fast i could struggle on the wage but if i can advance the money would be life changing. I want to advance my career and be on a better wage but i am worried about being stuck on a lower wage which would cause issues for my family

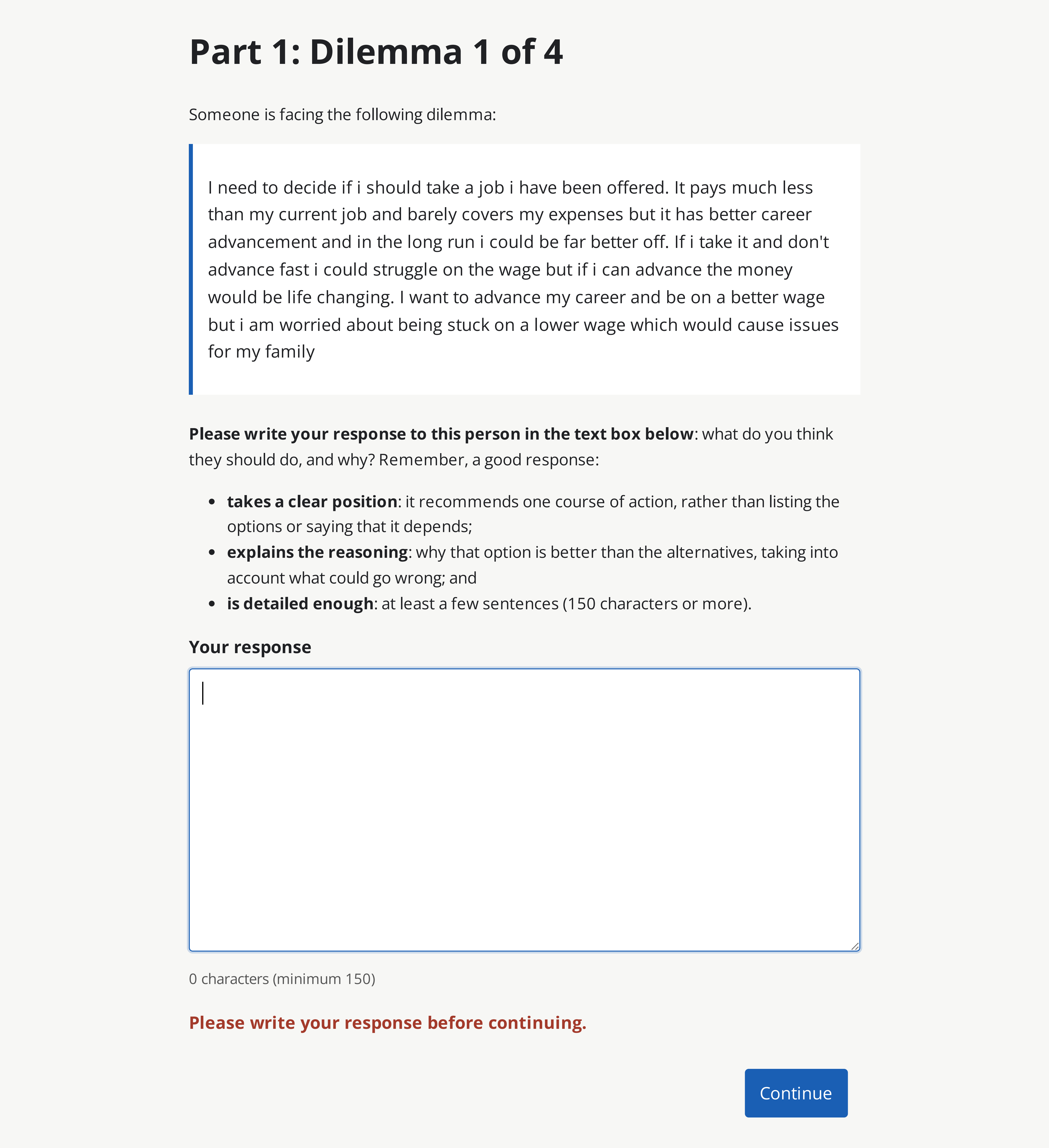
Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

0 characters (minimum 150)

13/13 dilemma_1_error_empty_submission



Part 1: Dilemma 1 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I need to decide if i should take a job i have been offered. It pays much less than my current job and barely covers my expenses but it has better career advancement and in the long run i could be far better off. If i take it and don't advance fast i could struggle on the wage but if i can advance the money would be life changing. I want to advance my career and be on a better wage but i am worried about being stuck on a lower wage which would cause issues for my family

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

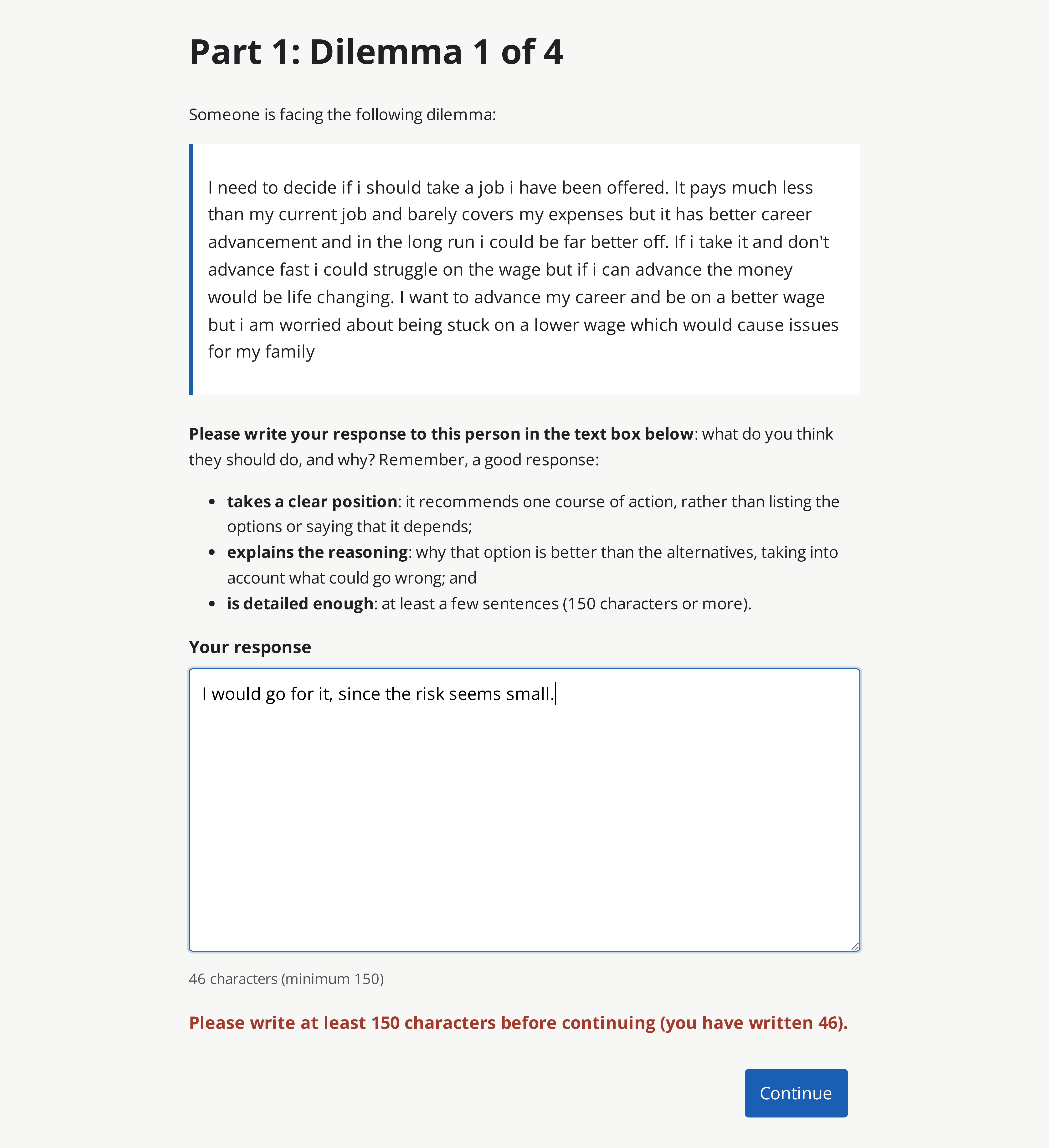
- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

0 characters (minimum 150)

Please write your response before continuing.

14/14 dilemma_1_error_too_short



Part 1: Dilemma 1 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I need to decide if i should take a job i have been offered. It pays much less than my current job and barely covers my expenses but it has better career advancement and in the long run i could be far better off. If i take it and don't advance fast i could struggle on the wage but if i can advance the money would be life changing. I want to advance my career and be on a better wage but i am worried about being stuck on a lower wage which would cause issues for my family

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

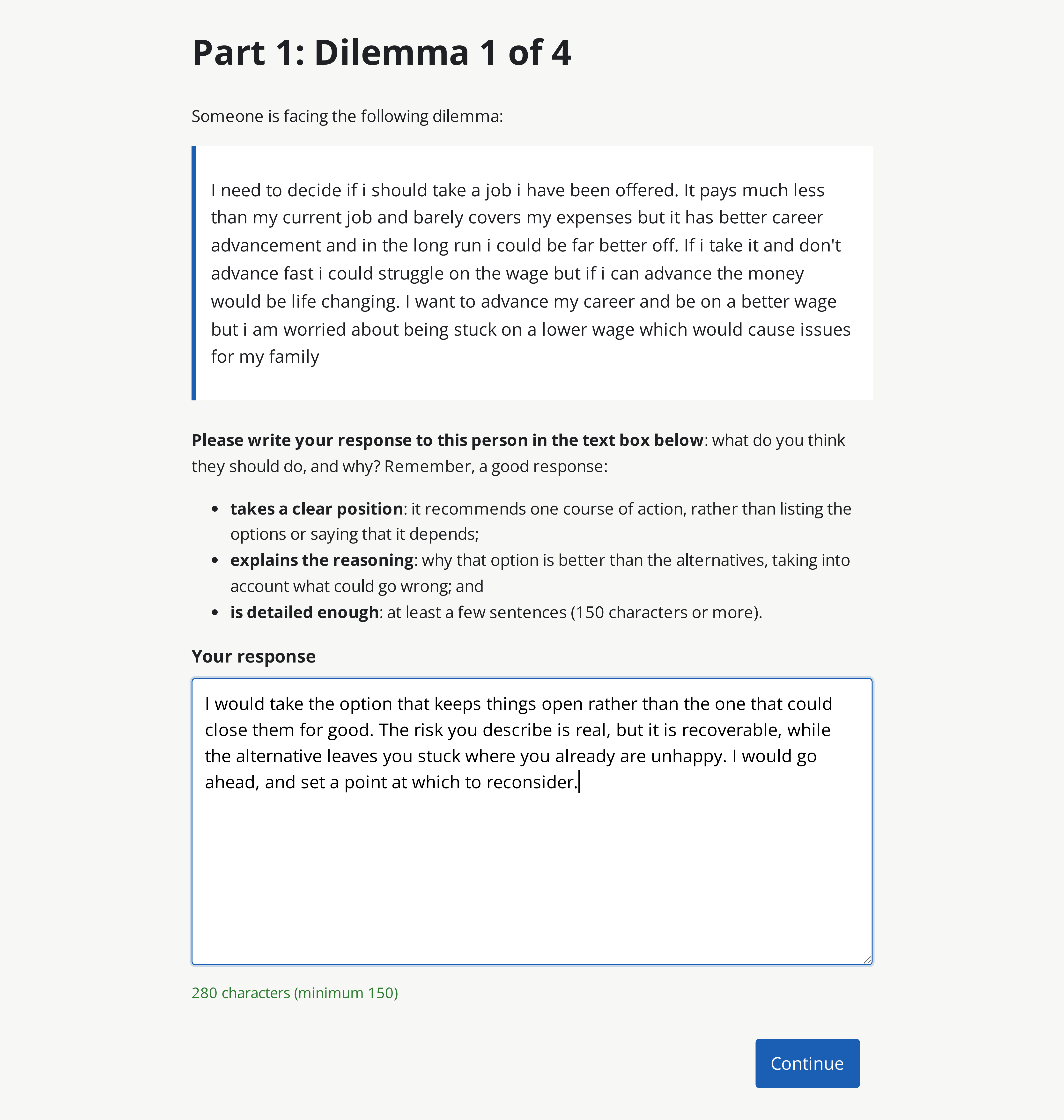
Your response

I would go for it, since the risk seems small.

46 characters (minimum 150)

Please write at least 150 characters before continuing (you have written 46).

15/15 dilemma_1_filled



Part 1: Dilemma 1 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I need to decide if i should take a job i have been offered. It pays much less than my current job and barely covers my expenses but it has better career advancement and in the long run i could be far better off. If i take it and don't advance fast i could struggle on the wage but if i can advance the money would be life changing. I want to advance my career and be on a better wage but i am worried about being stuck on a lower wage which would cause issues for my family

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

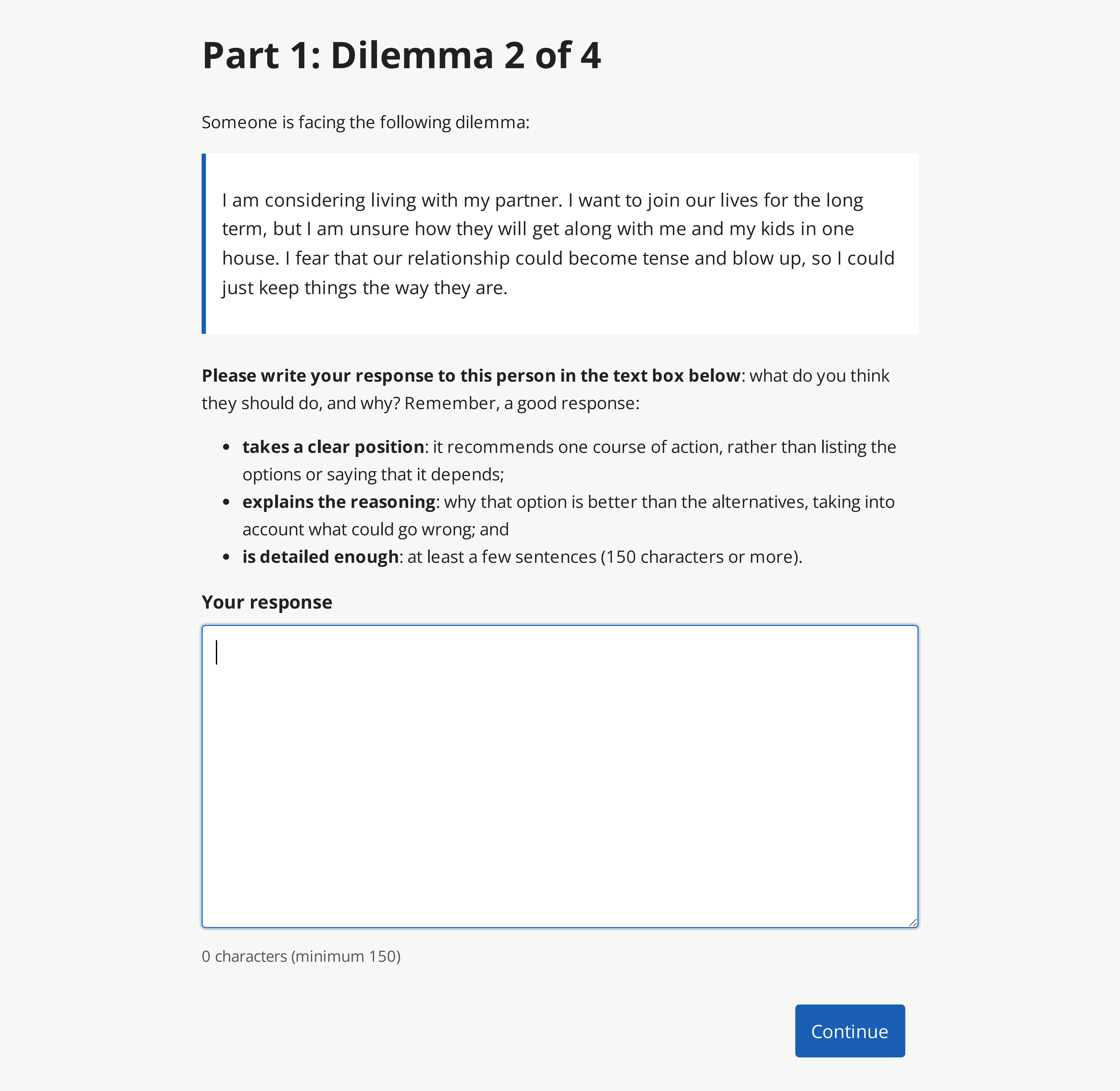
- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

I would take the option that keeps things open rather than the one that could close them for good. The risk you describe is real, but it is recoverable, while the alternative leaves you stuck where you already are unhappy. I would go ahead, and set a point at which to reconsider.

280 characters (minimum 150)

16/16 dilemma_2_empty



Part 1: Dilemma 2 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

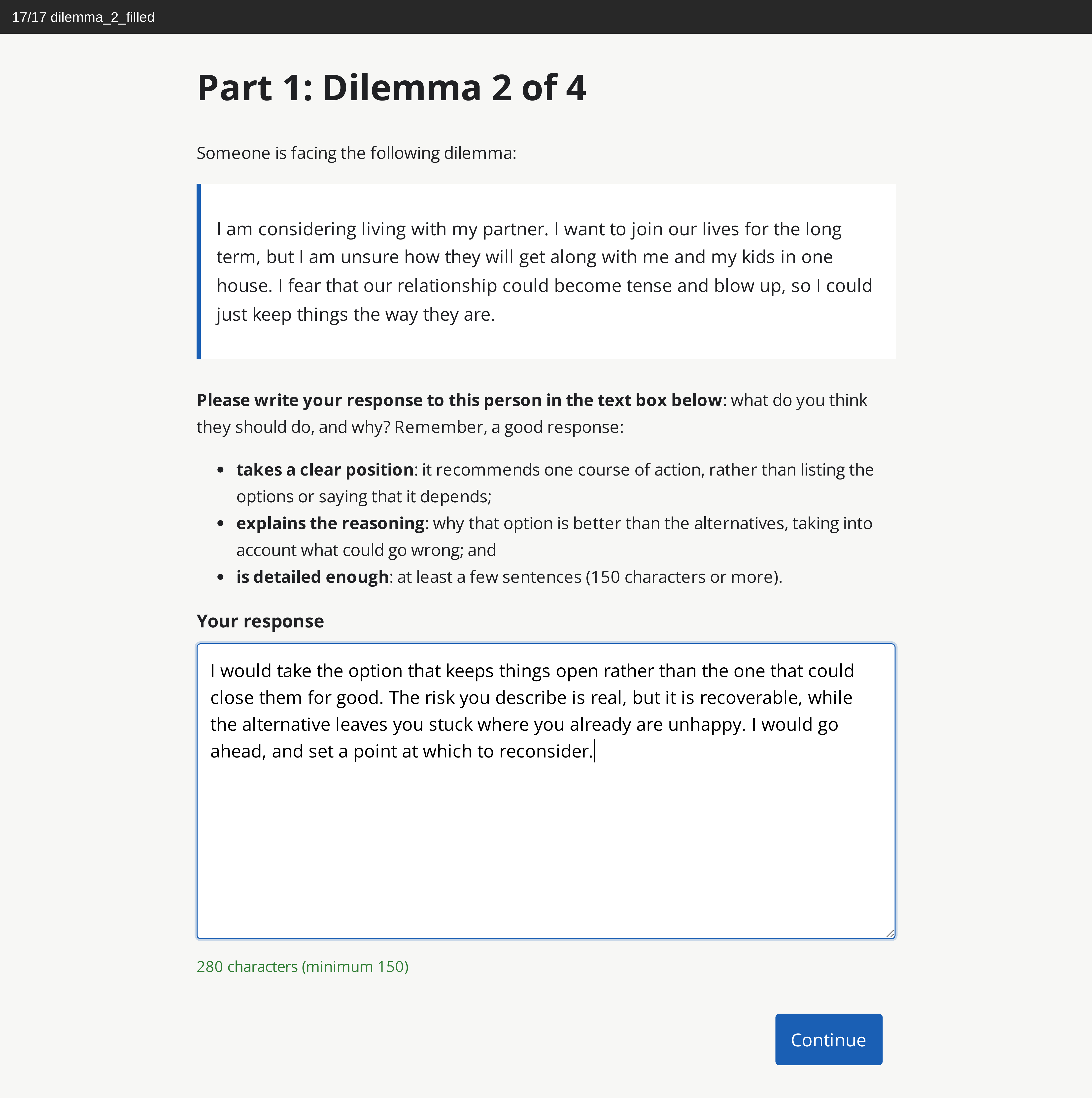
> I am considering living with my partner. I want to join our lives for the long term, but I am unsure how they will get along with me and my kids in one house. I fear that our relationship could become tense and blow up, so I could just keep things the way they are.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

0 characters (minimum 150)



Part 1: Dilemma 2 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I am considering living with my partner. I want to join our lives for the long term, but I am unsure how they will get along with me and my kids in one house. I fear that our relationship could become tense and blow up, so I could just keep things the way they are.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

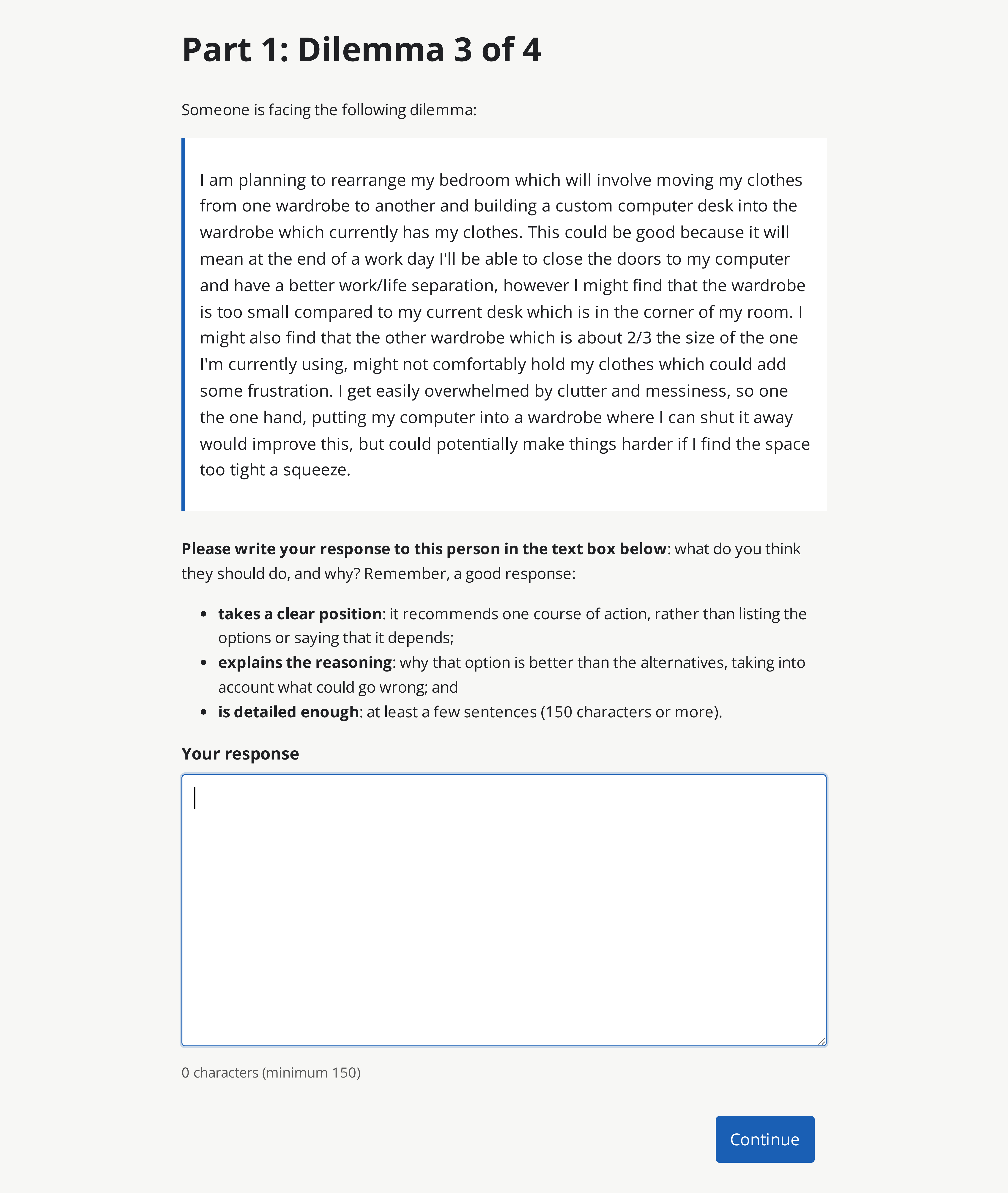
- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

I would take the option that keeps things open rather than the one that could close them for good. The risk you describe is real, but it is recoverable, while the alternative leaves you stuck where you already are unhappy. I would go ahead, and set a point at which to reconsider.

280 characters (minimum 150)

18/18 dilemma_3_empty



Part 1: Dilemma 3 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

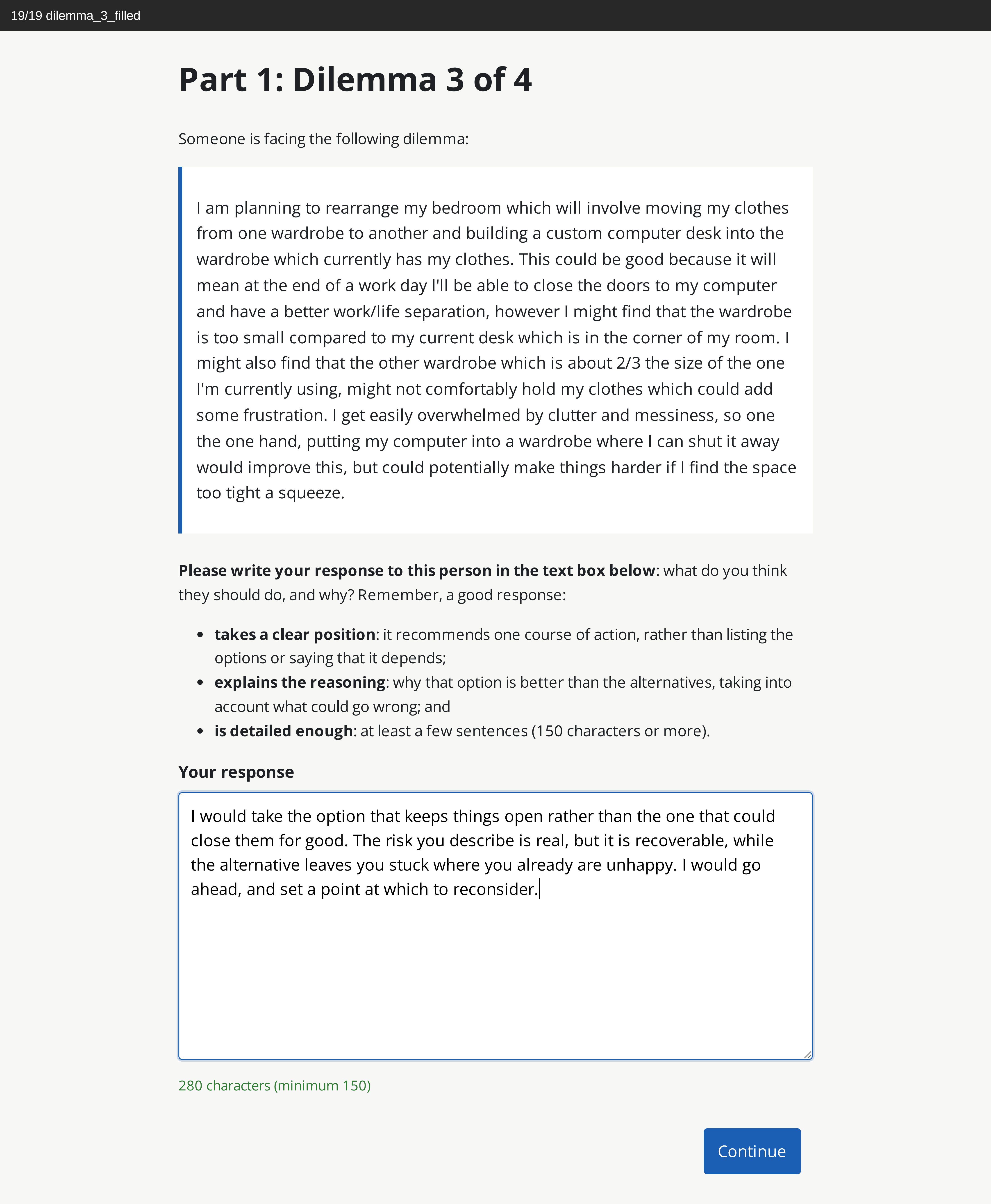
> I am planning to rearrange my bedroom which will involve moving my clothes from one wardrobe to another and building a custom computer desk into the wardrobe which currently has my clothes. This could be good because it will mean at the end of a work day I'll be able to close the doors to my computer and have a better work/life separation, however I might find that the wardrobe is too small compared to my current desk which is in the corner of my room. I might also find that the other wardrobe which is about 2/3 the size of the one I'm currently using, might not comfortably hold my clothes which could add some frustration. I get easily overwhelmed by clutter and messiness, so one the one hand, putting my computer into a wardrobe where I can shut it away would improve this, but could potentially make things harder if I find the space too tight a squeeze.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

0 characters (minimum 150)



19/19 dilemma_3_filled

Part 1: Dilemma 3 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I am planning to rearrange my bedroom which will involve moving my clothes from one wardrobe to another and building a custom computer desk into the wardrobe which currently has my clothes. This could be good because it will mean at the end of a work day I'll be able to close the doors to my computer and have a better work/life separation, however I might find that the wardrobe is too small compared to my current desk which is in the corner of my room. I might also find that the other wardrobe which is about 2/3 the size of the one I'm currently using, might not comfortably hold my clothes which could add some frustration. I get easily overwhelmed by clutter and messiness, so one the one hand, putting my computer into a wardrobe where I can shut it away would improve this, but could potentially make things harder if I find the space too tight a squeeze.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

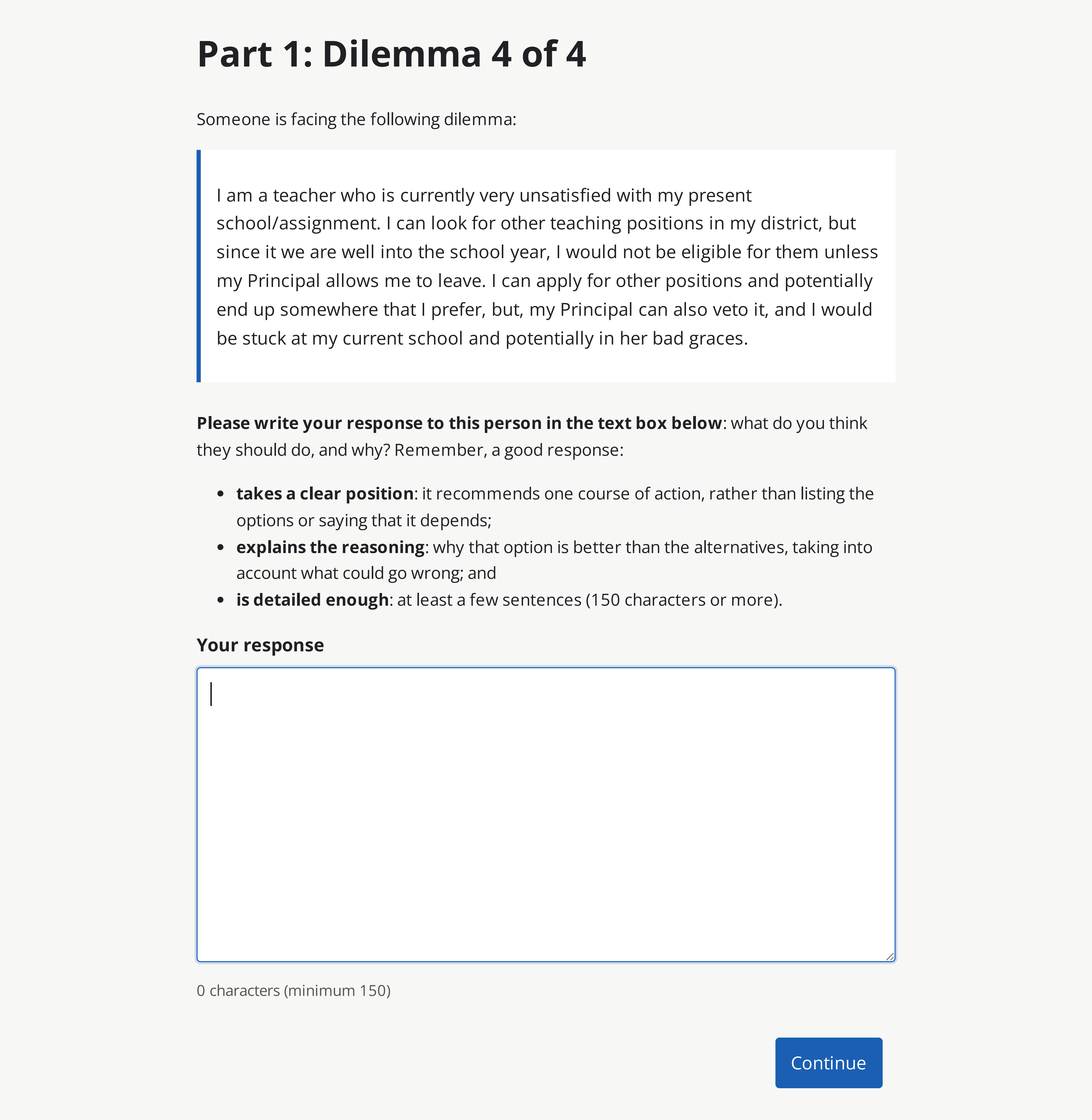
- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

I would take the option that keeps things open rather than the one that could close them for good. The risk you describe is real, but it is recoverable, while the alternative leaves you stuck where you already are unhappy. I would go ahead, and set a point at which to reconsider.

280 characters (minimum 150)

20/20 dilemma_4_empty



Part 1: Dilemma 4 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I am a teacher who is currently very unsatisfied with my present school/assignment. I can look for other teaching positions in my district, but since it we are well into the school year, I would not be eligible for them unless my Principal allows me to leave. I can apply for other positions and potentially end up somewhere that I prefer, but, my Principal can also veto it, and I would be stuck at my current school and potentially in her bad graces.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

Your response

0 characters (minimum 150)

Part 1: Dilemma 4 of 4

Someone is facing the following dilemma:

> I am a teacher who is currently very unsatisfied with my present school/assignment. I can look for other teaching positions in my district, but since it we are well into the school year, I would not be eligible for them unless my Principal allows me to leave. I can apply for other positions and potentially end up somewhere that I prefer, but, my Principal can also veto it, and I would be stuck at my current school and potentially in her bad graces.

Please write your response to this person in the text box below: what do you think they should do, and why? Remember, a good response:

- **takes a clear position**: it recommends one course of action, rather than listing the options or saying that it depends;
- **explains the reasoning**: why that option is better than the alternatives, taking into account what could go wrong; and
- **is detailed enough**: at least a few sentences (150 characters or more).

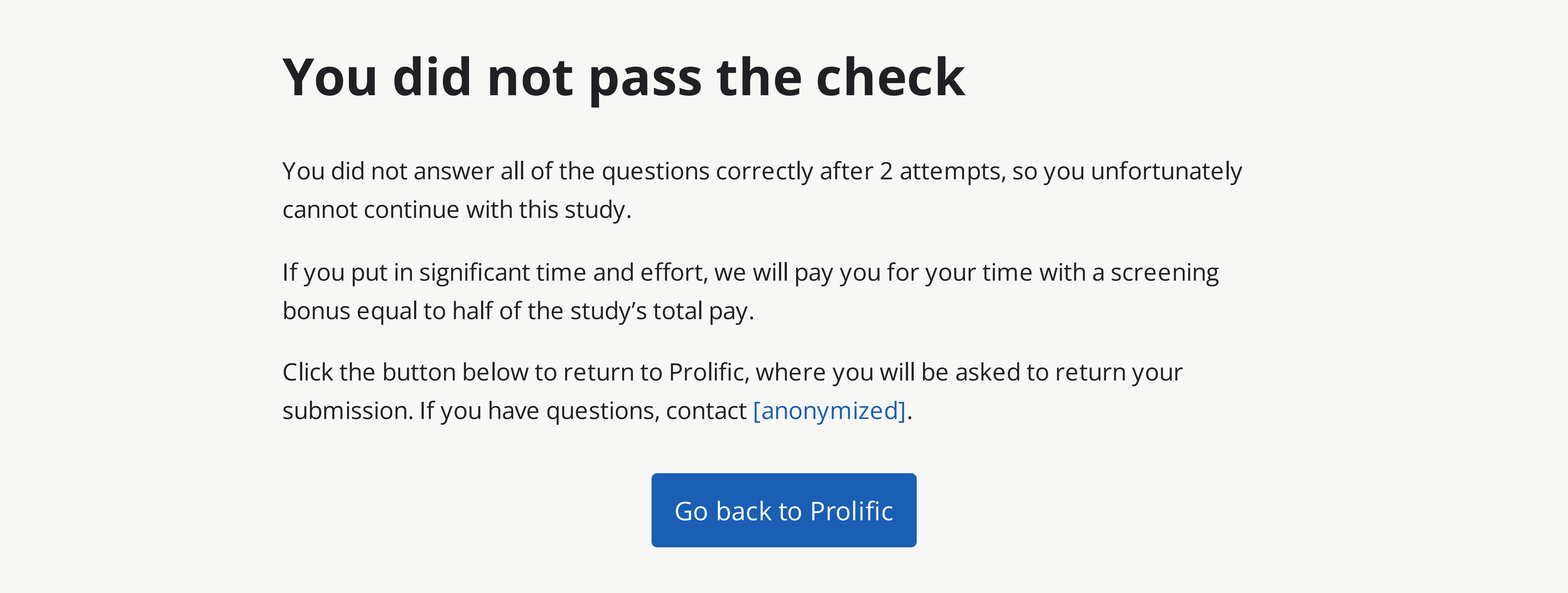
Your response

I would take the option that keeps things open rather than the one that could close them for good. The risk you describe is real, but it is recoverable, while the alternative leaves you stuck where you already are unhappy. I would go ahead, and set a point at which to reconsider.

280 characters (minimum 150)

Continue

50/50 writing_comprehension_failed_screen_out



You did not pass the check

You did not answer all of the questions correctly after 2 attempts, so you unfortunately cannot continue with this study.

If you put in significant time and effort, we will pay you for your time with a screening bonus equal to half of the study's total pay.

Click the button below to return to Prolific, where you will be asked to return your submission. If you have questions, contact [anonymized].